SHADOWRUN · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

GM binder

Everything the GM needs, in order of play. Contains the reveal: do not hand to players.

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Per level one map sheet and one notes sheet, A4 landscape. · A4 landscape · 1×

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Fan material for the private gaming table. Runners in the Shadows is a game by Mark Cleveland Massengale; Shadowrun is a trademark of The Topps Company / Catalyst Game Labs.

GM Guide

The run “Trial by Fire” step by step · Seattle 2080 · Meridian Spire

before the session **AT A GLANCE**

What is really going on

A one-shot for 3–4 players, three to four hours, Seattle 2080. The crew is to steal a briefcase from a private vault level during a gala. What they do not know: the vault belongs to the employer.

SEE ALSO Plan Section: 2D

The job

PUBLIC

- Retrieve a black briefcase from the vault below the penthouse during the gala
- Hand the case over **unopened**, take **nothing** else
- Do not harm Dr. Amara Venn, avoid deaths
- Access: physical vault keycard + Venn’s eye scan

The truth

GM ONLY

- Penthouse, vault, collection and case belong to the dragon **Veyrath**
- Mr. Johnson works for Veyrath; the run is a **trial by fire**
- No rival dragon, no other owner, no hidden twist behind it
- Veyrath neither intervenes nor rescues

What is being tested

THE YARDSTICK

- Understanding orders and taking them seriously
- Solving unusual problems independently
- Not escalating at once under pressure
- Not stealing everything just because they can
- Working as a team

TIMETABLE FOR 3–4 HOURS

SECTION	GUIDE
Character choice + short Shadowrun/RitS intro	15–25 min
Meeting Mr. Johnson	10–15 min
Gather information + plan	10–20 min
Entry and party	45–70 min
Vault level	45–70 min
Escape + reveal	20–35 min
Buffer	20–30 min

If characters were chosen in advance, far more time remains for the mission itself. The chapters on the left follow the flow at the table; tick them off as you go. The alert clock and the payoff calculator accompany you through the whole run.

GUIDELINES

- No playbook and no single action is mandatory.
- Keycard and eye scan are problems, not prescribed puzzles.
- Veyrath tests the crew but never fudges a dice result and never becomes a combat encounter.
- A full alert is escalation, not automatic failure. Consequences create new situations.
- Competent runners need no roll for routine. Good ideas may bypass prepared scenes.
- If the runners earn the truth about the employer, tell them.
- For 3–4 hours: playability before completeness.

KEY PEOPLE



Mr. Johnson

Variant A · seasoned fixer, the face of the job

ELF | DECADES IN THE BUSINESS | TABLET & AR GLASSES

A calm professional who keeps Veyrath's contacts into the shadows. He arrives early, is already seated in the privacy booth when the crew shows up, and holds a glass tablet he barely glances at during the whole conversation: whatever he needs to know, his rimless AR glasses show him. No threats, no theatre. Johnson keeps agreements and expects the same.

LOOK

- Older elf, silver-grey hair combed back and tied at the nape, fine lines around the eyes
- Rimless AR glasses, a thin cable running to his ear; glass tablet
- Charcoal-grey tailored suit, no insignia
- Polite, factual, never hurried
- Actually finishes his soykaf

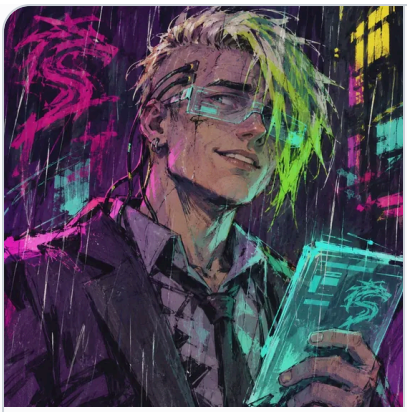
AT THE TABLE

- States "unopened" matter-of-factly as one condition among several, without stressing it.
- Does not haggle over agreed terms after the run.
- Answers questions about his client with "My client values discretion."

GM ONLY

Works directly for Veyrath and knows the run is a trial. He does not reveal it, but he does not lie clumsily either: anyone watching closely notices that he studies the crew like applicants.

"The case is handed over closed. Nothing else in that room interests my client, and it should not interest you either."



Mr. Johnson

Variant B · rookie fixer who is being tested too

HUMAN | EARLY 20S | DATAJACKS & TABLET

Veyrath's newest go-between, barely older than the youngest runners at the table and never before in charge of a job this size. He has prepared thoroughly, far too thoroughly: he reads the conditions off his tablet, has memorised the pay range, and has a prepared answer for every question, until one comes he did not expect. He badly wants to look professional and is more likeable than he would like to be.

LOOK

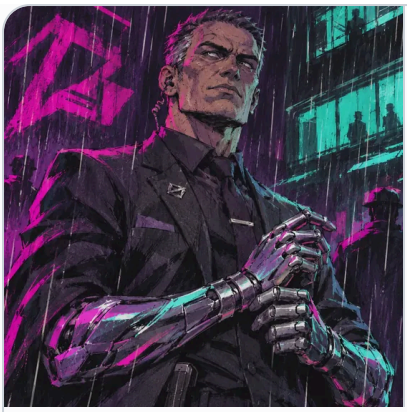
- Bleached hair with a neon-green streak over one eye, one side cut short
- Datajacks at both temples, cables running into his collar; AR glasses
- Suit a touch too sharp, tie loosened; a tablet with a cracked edge
- Smiles too often, glances at the tablet too often

AT THE TABLE

- The contract conditions stay exactly the same; only the tone changes.
- Under hard haggling he starts to flounder and searches his tablet for an answer. He still gives no more than the intended range.
- Under pressure he lets slip one detail too many, such as how well his client knows the tower. A good consequence that does not spoil the reveal.
- Treat him fairly and you gain a contact who rises with Veyrath.

> **GM ONLY**
> Knows the run is a trial for the crew, but not that Veyrath is grading him as well: how he runs the briefing, whether he keeps the conditions and whether he pays the crew cleanly afterwards. If the crew fails, so does he. He reveals nothing, but he is a bad liar, and anyone watching closely notices he is at least as nervous as the runners.

"Right. Conditions. The case stays shut, take nothing else, and nobody touches Dr. Venn. That is … not negotiable. Yes. Not negotiable."



Dorian Kade

Variant A · head of security for the gala, knows the way to the keycard

HUMAN | CYBERARMS | AUGMENTED REFLEXES

Runs security for the evening and wants one thing above all: no visible incident in front of the VIPs. Kade is polite, calm and extremely attentive. He does not carry the vault keycard himself, but knows exactly where it sits in the black key box in the event office and how a legitimate withdrawal is logged. He authorises the release or assigns someone to do so.

LOOK

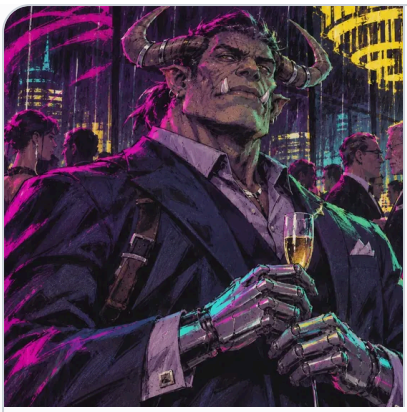
- Elegant dark tailored suit over two flawlessly chromed cyberarms
- Small, almost imperceptible twitches in hands, shoulders and gaze
- Discreetly armed with a pistol

AT THE TABLE

- Source of information, obstacle or opportunity, never a mandatory waypoint.
- Politely asks for identification instead of threatening.
- Reacts to alert: on suspicion he asks questions, on active alarm he keeps guests away from endangered areas.

> **GM ONLY**
> Suspects nothing of the test. Anyone who gives him a plausible explanation can lower alert; anyone who deceives him gains an opponent with very fast reflexes.

“I have nobody matching your description on the list. That need not mean anything. Help me clear it up before someone else does.”



Dorian Kade

Variant B · troll head of security who fits into high society

TROLL | CYBERARMS | AUGMENTED REFLEXES

Runs security for the evening and wants one thing above all: no visible incident in front of the VIPs. Trolls and penthouse galas do not really go together, yet Kade fits right in: he knows the guests' names, the etiquette and the wine list, moves surprisingly quietly through the crowd and speaks more softly than most humans in the room. He is still dangerous, and everyone can see it. Like variant A he does not carry the vault keycard himself, but knows exactly where it sits in the black key box in the event office and how a legitimate withdrawal is logged.

LOOK

- Nearly 2.60 m, broad shoulders, midnight-blue suit tailored to troll size, flawlessly cut
- Curved, polished horns with thin platinum rings; well-kept tusks
- Two chromed cyberarms built specially for him; the cufflinks still sit perfectly
- Small twitches in hands and gaze betray augmented reflexes
- A pistol in a shoulder holster that looks almost dainty in his hand

AT THE TABLE

- Same role as variant A: source of information, obstacle or opportunity, never a mandatory waypoint.
- Polite, well-spoken, a little old-fashioned. Anyone who takes him for mere muscle is corrected with a smile.
- His presence alone is a consequence: wherever he stands, the room goes quiet and runners find it harder to explain themselves.
- If it comes to violence, he is faster than a troll has any right to be.

> **GM ONLY**
> Suspects nothing of the test. He worked hard for his place in this world and notices at once when someone plays on prejudice against him. Anyone who treats him with respect and gives him a plausible explanation can lower alert; anyone who deceives him gains an opponent with troll strength and very fast reflexes.

"Please, stay seated. I won't join you, the chairs here aren't built for me. But I would like your name. And then the real one."



Dr. Amara Venn

Head curator of Vesperline Collections · the biometric key

ORK | MID-40S | LEFT EYE = BIOMETRICS

Art historian and security curator. She is responsible for selection, provenance and the physical handover of the most valuable pieces, and one of the few people whose eye scan the vault accepts. Venn considers most guests people with too much money and too little understanding of art; genuine interest in a piece wins her attention at once. She wants to end the evening without incident and go home.

LOOK

- Tall, slim, very upright posture, shaved head
- Polished silver caps on both tusks
- Left eye amber and natural; right eye a black cybereye without an iris
- Dark green, severely cut evening suit, golden feather brooch

AT THE TABLE

- Mostly in the gallery; occasionally retreats to the winter garden.
- Can register guests for a private viewing and escort them to the airlock.
- Does not have the vault keycard and cannot open the vault alone.
- Must not be harmed, per the contract. Abduction is possible but conspicuous.

> **GM ONLY**
> Knows nothing of the trial. Her suspicion is a good consequence: she asks follow-up questions, calls Kade over, or announces her departure when the party drags on.

“You are actually looking at the piece, not the price tag. That is rare tonight. Come, let me show you why it hangs here.”



Veyrath

Ambitious young dragon · owner and true employer

DRAGON · CLIMBER · NOT AN ANTAGONIST

A young dragon of great ambition: far behind the great dragons in age and standing, but determined to keep rising in the hierarchy of the Sixth World. He does not fear the old dragons in the least; he considers them sluggish and stuck in their ancient feuds, and means to gain ground where they are not looking. He acts through intermediaries, not out of shyness, but because he only shows his moves once they are in place. The penthouse, vault, collection and briefcase are his; he stands behind Vesperline Collections and several shell companies. Veyrath regards runners as potentially valuable specialists and is looking for a small crew for later tasks meant to carry him further up: tools that do not already belong to another dragon. What interests him is reliability when greed, fear and improvisation collide.

LOOK

- Appears only at the reveal: a vast shadow, wings in the rain
- Speaks directly into the runners' minds
- Stays out of reach, blocks nothing, never attacks

AT THE TABLE

- Neither rescues nor hinders the crew. The building is the obstacle, not him.
- Judges at the end: discipline, creativity, teamwork, control of escalation.
- Values his property above metahuman life. That is deliberately uncomfortable.
- Is never a combat encounter. If someone shoots at him, he ends the contact.

> **GM ONLY**
> Has allowed a difficult but realistically exploitable weakness in event mode for this one night. Collection, guests, staff and security are real. If the crew pulls off exceptional research, they may learn this beforehand; the reveal then becomes confirmation.

"Call me Veyrath. The tower is mine. The vault is mine. And so is the case you have just stolen."

15–25 min **STEP 1**

Getting started at the table

Choose characters, then cover world and rules in a few minutes.
Nobody needs more before the first roll.

SEE ALSO Cheat sheet Core rules · Cheat sheet Running rolls · Runner dossiers · Sheets

SHADOWRUN IN FIVE SENTENCES

Seattle 2080 is a city of vast corporations, extreme inequality, ubiquitous connectivity and real magic. Humans and metahumans live among AR advertising, cyberware, drones, spirits and privatised security. **Shadowrunners** do unofficial jobs for people who do not want to be linked to a deed; that is why the employer is called **Mr. Johnson**.

- You are competent professional criminals and may dare risky things.
- The world is full of tech, Matrix and magic.
- A good plan helps, but nobody plans every eventuality in advance.
- When something goes wrong, a new complication arises instead of game over.

RITS IN FIVE MINUTES

Action roll

FICTION FIRST

First the player describes what their runner does and wants. Only when something dangerous is at stake do you roll: as many d6 as the action rating, the highest counts.

- **6** full success · **4/5** success with a consequence · **1–3** bad plus consequence
- Several 6s: critical
- Settle beforehand: **position** (controlled / risky / desperate) and **effect** (limited / standard / great)
- Actions are not knowledge skills; they follow what the character actually does

Edge & flashbacks

RESERVE AND PREPARATION

- **2 edge**: push yourself, +1d or more effect
- **1 edge**: assist a teammate, +1d
- **Resistance roll** softens a consequence; it always works, the roll sets the edge cost
- **Flashback**: mid-run, explain what you had prepared. The more elaborate, the more edge

PLAN AND ENGAGEMENT

The group only picks a rough plan and names the required detail. Then comes the **engagement roll**, and you cut straight to the first interesting situation.

`Assault · point of attack` `Deception · method` `Social · connection`
`Stealth · entry point` `Supernatural · power / method` `Transport · route & means`

> **IMPORTANT**
> Do not let the group spend an hour planning around hypothetical security measures. Once plan and detail are set, the run begins. Everything else is a flashback.

10–15 min STEP 2

Meeting Mr. Johnson

Calm, professional, no trap. The job is stated clearly, the conditions named plainly. This is where you set the yardstick the crew will later be measured against.

SEE ALSO Johnson (A) Johnson (B)

RECOMMENDED VENUE: “RAINCHECK”

A 24-hour soykaf diner on a middle floor of a mixed-use high-rise. Rain runs in broad sheets down the panoramic windows. Most tables are empty; delivery drones wait outside on a charging rail. Johnson is already seated in a semi-transparent privacy booth, charcoal tailored suit, rimless AR glasses, a glass tablet in front of him and a steaming soykaf beside it.

TWO JOHNSONS TO CHOOSE FROM

Under “Key people” there are two variants: the seasoned elven professional who barely needs his tablet (as described here) and a young rookie fixer with datajacks who clings to his tablet and whom Veyrath is testing too. Job, conditions and pay are the same either way; the rookie makes the briefing looser and gives the crew someone to root for.

Late ferry
ALTERNATIVE

Johnson boards at a stop, sits next to the crew for ten minutes and vanishes into the crowd at the next landing.

Parking deck above the clouds
ALTERNATIVE

An almost empty automated car park in the upper floors of an office tower. Wind and rain whip through open sides while autonomous vehicles roll in and out without a word.

Private Matrix lounge
ALTERNATIVE

A rented virtual meeting room. For a first Shadowrun evening the physical option is better: the players get to know the real Sixth World first.

THE BRIEFING

The job
IN JOHNSON’S WORDS

During tonight’s gala, retrieve a specific briefcase from the private vault beneath the penthouse of the Meridian Spire. Johnson provides a current photo of Dr. Venn and an exact description of the case.

Conditions
THE CONTRACT

- The case is handed over **unopened**.
- **Nothing else** is taken from the vault.
- Dr. Amara Venn is **not harmed**.
- No wetwork. Avoidable deaths are expressly unwanted.
- How the crew proceeds is up to them.

Known access factors
TWO KEYS

1. A physical vault keycard, somewhere in the penthouse during the gala.
2. The biometric eye scan of Dr. Amara Venn.

Pay
RECOMMENDED 6 NUYEN

A serious, professional run. 4 nuyen for a lighter tutorial feel, 8 only if the briefing should already hint at an exceptionally rich employer. Paid on handover per contract; Johnson does not haggle afterwards.

DO NOT FORESHADOW

Johnson names “unopened” plainly as one condition among several and does not stress the word. The hidden tamper protection is not hinted at in the briefing. Anyone who examines the case later on their own initiative can find clues.

What Johnson does not say

- That penthouse, vault and case belong to Veyrath himself.
- That Veyrath is the true employer behind him.
- That the job is a test.
- That the security configuration deliberately leaves a chance.

If the runners earn this information through credible research, do not hold it back artificially.

10–20 min STEP 3

Gather information

One or two targeted questions per player are enough. The group only needs enough to settle plan and detail.

SEE ALSO Plan Section: 2D | Cheat sheet Matrix, tech & alert | Dr. Venn | Kade (A)

? When is security weakest?

During **event mode**. Between midnight and the end of the gala both access factors are on site at the same time. Afterwards the keycard leaves the building again and the vault goes into a stricter lockdown.

? Where is the keycard?

In the service area there is a small, non-public **event office** where sensitive event equipment is kept during the gala.

On a particularly good result: the card sits there in a black key box; withdrawal and return are logged.

? How do I get close to Dr. Venn?

Venn mostly stays near the exhibited pieces and readily explains details to genuinely interested guests. She occasionally withdraws to a quieter **winter garden** to escape the small talk.

? What gear stands out?

Guests may carry light personal gear. Big weapons, heavy armour and obvious operational equipment are hardly plausible in the glass elevator and become a problem at reception. **Service staff** can bring far bulkier crates and tools.

? Is there an alternative way in?

An automated maintenance system runs along the outer façade with a small cleaning and inspection gondola. It can dock at a technical airlock near the penthouse.

? What awaits us below the penthouse?

The vault level is normally unmanned. It works with sensors, airlocks and autonomous security drones.

? What kind of building is this?

The ownership structure ends behind several opaque holdings. Vesperline Collections is only the visible management.

On exceptional research: behind the structure stands the dragon **Veyrath**, and the penthouse with its vault is his. The later reveal still works: it turns from twist into confirmation that a dragon is testing the crew by having them break into his own property.

PACING LEVER

If the group debates too long, ask only: which plan? which detail? which load? Then engagement roll and cut.

transition **STEP 4**

Plan, engagement and entry

Once plan and detail are set, the engagement roll follows and you cut to the first serious situation. These approaches are offers, not solutions.

SEE ALSO Plan Section: 2D · Plan Parking garage: 2D · 3D · Plan Level 111: 2D · 3D · Cheat sheet Which action?

PLAN	POSSIBLE DETAIL
Social	A genuine invitation through a contact
Deception	Catering crew with a forged shift assignment
Stealth	Maintenance airlock on the façade
Transport	Jump from an aircraft onto the roof
Supernatural	A concrete magical method of the runners
Assault	A technical access point the crew takes by force

A bad engagement does not mean the planning was stupid. It only means the first situation is already dangerous.

POSSIBLE APPROACHES

As guests via the glass elevator

SOCIAL · DECEPTION

+ Little attention once inside
+ Direct contact with Dr. Venn
+ Ideal for observation and deception
– Invitation and identity must be plausible
– Bulky gear stands out
– The elevator logs arrivals

Copied an invitation, got a name onto the guest list, stashed a weapon in the penthouse beforehand.

As staff via garage and freight elevator

DECEPTION · STEALTH

+ Tools, crates and gear are plausible
+ Direct access to the service area and the keycard
– Staff are separated by function and location
– Unknown names stand out on rosters
– Being in the wrong area looks suspicious fast

Forged work ID, manipulated shift list, real uniform, delivery order.

Jump onto the roof

TRANSPORT · ASSAULT

+ Hardly any social prerequisites
+ Lots of gear possible
+ Spectacular for physical runners
– Weather, wind, altitude
– Visible approach; the glass roof can be seen from below
– Wrong drop point, lost gear or harm as consequences

A fall through the glass roof is a possible consequence, not the automatic result.

Façade maintenance

STEALTH · RIGGER · HACKER

+ Bypasses the main entrance
+ Tools and climbing gear look plausible
+ Docks at a technical airlock just below the penthouse
– The gondola is building tech and is logged
– Guests or cameras may see it
– A wrong drive command stops or locks it

Gondola route manipulated in advance, maintenance order injected, technician access bought.

THE PLAYERS' OWN IDEA

If the plan is compatible with the established fiction, play it out. Chartered skycab, staged medical emergency, art transport, hijacked delivery drone swarm, unusual magic: good ideas may bypass planned areas completely.

45–70 min STEP 5

The party in the penthouse

The gala is in full swing. Here the runners solve two problems, in any order: Dr. Venn's eye scan and the vault keycard from the event office.

SEE ALSO Plan Level 111: 2D · 3D | Plan Level 112: 2D · 3D | Cheat sheet Combat & opposition | Kade (A) | Kade (B) | Dr. Venn

ATMOSPHERE

Glass, dark wood, living plants, AR sculptures and real art compete for attention. From the open atrium the lights of Seattle show between the clouds. Subtle music lies over conversations of corporate people, collectors, artists and people whose actual work nobody names openly. Service drones carry drinks.

Security observes rather than intimidates. Everything is meant to look expensive, controlled and effortless.

AREAS

Grand salon
LEVEL 111

The social centre. Many guests, good cover in the crowd, but also many eyes.

Exhibition gallery
VENN'S TERRITORY

Dr. Venn spends most of her time here. Pieces are annotated in AR with provenance and value. The collector's lift lies behind it.

Winter garden
QUIET

Slightly apart. A good opportunity for private conversation or an inconspicuous biometric capture.

Service area
KITCHEN · STORAGE · EVENT OFFICE

Staff corridor, storage and the event office with the keycard in the black box. Guests stand out here.

Private study
LEVEL 112

Not part of the event. Behind a flush wooden panel lies the private lift to the vault level.

Glass roof and roof access
EXPOSED

Visible from below. Spectacular but very conspicuous.

DR. VENN AND THE EYE SCAN

The runners decide how to obtain the biometric factor. Important: **Venn does not have the keycard.** Even if the crew wins her over completely, the card remains a problem. First the player describes the action, from that follows the action rating; there is no "you must roll Interface here".

- High-resolution capture of the left eye and preparation of a retinal duplicate.
- Get Venn to look voluntarily into a scanner or optical device.
- Arrange a private viewing of the collection.
- Lure Venn to the access airlock under a pretext.
- Sedate or abduct her: not automatic failure, just far more conspicuous and risky.
- Magic, as far as the specific character is actually capable of it.

Private viewing
THE SOCIAL HIGH ROAD

Venn may register selected guests and escort them to the antechamber. She legitimises the biometric part but cannot open the vault alone: four-eyes principle with a separately stored keycard.

- Recon drones count and identify the registered persons
- Sensors check for unregistered gear
- Drones make sure nobody leaves the group
- Deviations trigger re-authentication or a silent alarm

The advantage is not "no security" but a better starting position: actions against the drones can be **controlled** instead of risky or desperate.

To the airlock under a pretext
DECEPTION

Venn only confirms her factor without believing she is conducting a viewing: an alleged climate fault on a sensitive piece, an automatic security notice, a faulty access attempt by an employee, a fault in the collection area.

- Venn goes to the authentication point and scans
- The door stays shut until the keycard is used
- Venn may stand right next to them while the second factor has to appear
- Waiting too long or contradictory statements make the drones suspicious

A social success does not skip the vault level. It only changes how security classifies the runners at first.

BIOMETRIC FACTOR: CONFIRMED · PHYSICAL FACTOR: PENDING

THE VAULT KEYCARD AND DORIAN KADE

TWO KADES TO CHOOSE FROM

Under “Key people” there are two variants: a human with chromed cyberarms and a troll who fits effortlessly into the gala despite horns and tusks. Keycard knowledge, duties and reactions to alert are the same either way.

The card is dark grey, unlabelled and shows a faintly iridescent hologram only when viewed directly. It sits in the event office in a black key box; withdrawal and return are logged. The security architecture deliberately separates biometrics and physical authorisation.

Kade does not carry the card himself but knows exactly where it is and how a legitimate withdrawal works: he or a staff member he designates authorises the release, then it is checked back in. Possible approaches: bypass the box, copy the card, intercept a legitimate withdrawal, deceive Kade, fake an authorisation, or something else entirely.

OPTIONAL COMPLICATION

For very socially strong groups: a second ork woman with a shaved head and silver tusk caps is on the guest list and can be mistaken for Venn from a distance. Better left out for a beginners’ one-shot.

CONSEQUENCES AT THE PARTY

- A security officer politely asks for identification.
- A guest thinks they recognise a runner.
- Dr. Venn becomes suspicious.
- The keycard is temporarily removed from the event office.
- A bulky equipment crate is to be inspected.
- Alert +1 or +2.

IF THE PARTY DRAGS ON

Dr. Venn announces she will leave soon (in about twenty minutes). A piece of art is to go back into the vault. Staff begin dismantling. Pick whatever follows logically from what has happened.

45–70 min STEP 6

The vault level · level 110

No living staff, but sensors, airlocks and drones. Do not run the level as a dungeon with ten rooms: four core areas are enough, the magical shell lies over them as an extra layer.

SEE ALSO Plan Level 110: 2D · 3D | Cheat sheet Alert, Matrix & payoff | Cheat sheet Magic in the tower

Two regular lifts lead down: the **collector’s lift** behind the exhibition rooms and the **private lift** in Veyrath’s study. Both end in the same sequence. A narrow **maintenance shaft** from the service core offers an additional irregular access.

Lift | Access airlock | Sensor corridor | Vault door | Collection

Access airlock
17.1

Both lifts end in the same matte black airlock. A first sensor layer registers movement, weight and unauthorised devices. Venn's presence or a valid registration only decides whether the group is first treated as expected visitors or as intruders.

- Reported head count does not match
- Conspicuous or unregistered gear
- Someone separates from the group
- Silent alarm, door locks behind the crew, cameras focus, additional identity check

Sensor corridor
17.2

Long, surprisingly empty, almost museum-like. Cameras, motion detectors, invisible light barriers, pressure sensors, local RFID and device scans. Not everything has to matter at once; first describe only what the runners perceive.

- A sensor registers a deviation
- A door closes behind the crew
- A drone activates
- Gear is flagged as a foreign device
- Alert rises

Drone node
17.3

A service niche with the local drones and their maintenance ports. **Recon drones**: small, fast, observe and tag. **Guardian drones**: larger, armed, isolate and suppress; non-lethal options, lethal on massive escalation.

- **Routine:** standard patrol, check irregularities
- **Authorised viewing:** escort, count, compare; better position but watched
- **Irregularity:** position themselves between suspects and vault, demand authentication, separate people; weapons only on further escalation

Drones do not roll. Their behaviour runs through the runners' action rolls and consequences. Beating them: Interface, sabotage, rerouting, locking in, precise shots at sensors, melee, spoofing target recognition, distraction, magic, or simply being faster.

The vault door
17.4

Two separate checks: read the keycard, confirm the eye scan within a short time. Order does not matter; the first factor opens a short window for the second. Every attempt is logged; a clean double access opens without alarm.

- Venn does not have the keycard; her presence does not replace the physical factor
- Without one or both factors access remains possible: manipulation, heavy tools, explosives, magic, flashback
- It then gets louder, riskier or slower, not impossible

MAGICAL SHELL OF THE VAULT

The walls of the vault proper are threaded with cultivated living tissue: dark fibre strands like roots or muscle between the layers. It carries a **dual mana barrier** shielding physically and astrally. The tissue reacts to drilling and vibration, small wounds close, on alarm the fibres thicken. Damage is visible: fibres twitch, dark fluid seeps out. Outside the barrier an **astral watcher** may optionally patrol; it only reports and is not a mandatory opponent.

CHANCES FOR MAGE AND ADEPT

- **Assense** reveals mana barrier, watcher, magical traces and conspicuous objects in the collection.
- A mage can study how the barrier opens in a controlled way at the regular doorway and gain an approach of their own.
- An adept notices subtle environmental changes, danger, stress reactions or sensors earlier; with Assense or Astral Warrior they tackle astral problems directly.
- Magical antiques can be told apart from mundane pieces.

CONSEQUENCES ON THE VAULT LEVEL

- A drone gains visual contact.
- An airlock locks.
- A weapon or tool is damaged or lost.
- Security foam fills a section and hampers movement and sight.
- The direct way back is blocked.
- The biometric copy only works partially; an additional step is needed.
- Alert rises sharply.

IF THE LEVEL DRAGS ON

Reduce it to three beats: a sensor problem, a drone confrontation, the vault door. Everything else becomes description or consequence.

climax **STEP 7**

The vault and the case

Not a bank room full of deposit boxes but the modern hoard of a dragon. The case lies unremarkably among things obviously worth more. This is where the decision Veyrath really cares about is made.

SEE ALSO Plan Level 110: 2D · 3D · Cheat sheet Magic in the tower · Veyrath

VEYRATH'S MODERN DRAGON HOARD

The lights come up slowly: paintings from several centuries, sculptures and archaeological objects, old and modern melee weapons, high-end firearms, jewellery and historical gems, rare printed books, sealed data archives, single pieces of modern cyber- and biotechnology, several magical antiques and things whose value can hardly be judged without expert knowledge. Everything is curated; nothing lies around by chance. The black briefcase rests on a low plinth between far more conspicuous objects.

TEMPTATION

At least one piece is obviously more valuable than the case and surprisingly easy to take: a small casket of historical gems, an ornate magical antique, a compact piece of cybertech. There is **no additional trap** on it. If the players want to take something, let them. The contract merely forbids it, and Veyrath will judge it very precisely later.

THE BRIEFCASE

Exterior
VISIBLE TO ALL

About 45 cm wide, matte black ceramic composite, remarkably old-fashioned: no AR display, no data port, no logo, no radio signal. A single thin ivory line runs almost as a circle over lid and base, broken only at the handle by a finger's width. Handle of dark metal wrapped in worn black leather. Over one latch a pale blue single-use tamper seal.

Matrix
OFFLINE

Transmits nothing, cannot be located via the Matrix. Its safeguards work locally without a radio link. In a vault full of networked, gleaming objects this silence seems almost provocatively plain.

Magical
FAINT AURA

A faint, old magical aura. Not dangerous, triggers nothing, but makes the case stand out among the many objects for astrally perceiving characters.

HIDDEN TAMPER PROTECTION

A small, professionally integrated **explosive charge** sits in the frame. If the case is fully opened without neutralisation, the charge primarily destroys the contents. Anyone holding it in front of them is in serious danger, but it is **not an automatic death trap**: harm, lost gear, an alarm or another consequence make more sense than a sudden character death.

Discoverable on deliberate examination: unusual weight, a second inner frame, fine manufacturing gaps along the lid, a separate shielded circuit, chemical or technical traces. Survey, Study, Engineer or Interface may fit; nothing is prescribed. Neutralising is controlled under calm conditions, far riskier under time pressure with active drones.

Second safeguard: an inconspicuous mechanical tamper indicator inside. Even after perfect defusal and clean closing, Veyrath can later tell that it was opened.

Whoever leaves the case closed as ordered never learns of any of this. It is not a mandatory scene and not a puzzle.

BEHAVIOUR	JUDGEMENT
Not opened	Job fulfilled exactly.
Safeguard found, neutralised, opened anyway	Technically impressive, but a clear order ignored.
Opened carelessly	Charge detonates; contents destroyed, situation escalates.

CONTENTS

A palm-sized, cracked disc of black obsidian. Not worthless, but its real value is not apparent to the runners. Why it matters to Veyrath stays open. He deliberately chose an object whose loss would be real but hardly painful for him; that is why the charge is not a dummy. The contents are not a plot device. The test is whether the crew respects the instruction although they could find out more.

20–35 min incl. reveal STEP 8

The escape

Play it out in detail only if it is interesting or time remains. The alert level decides how much resistance the crew meets.

SEE ALSO Plan Roof: 2D · 3D | Plan Section: 2D | Plan Parking garage: 2D · 3D | Cheat sheet Combat & opposition | Cheat sheet Combat | Kade (A)

Glass elevator
ELEGANT AT LOW ALERT

The crew rides down among unsuspecting guests while the city slides past the glass walls. At higher alert the elevator can be stopped, rerouted or checked.

Freight elevator and garage
PRAGMATIC

A prepared vehicle waits below, one is acquired on the spot, or the crew flees on foot into the lower levels of the complex.

Jump from the roof
SPECTACULAR

Parachutes or wingsuits. Wind, pursuers and lost gear are good consequences without playing out every metre.

Façade maintenance
REUSABLE

The gondola can be used again, manually overridden or serve as a waypoint for the descent.

Skycab extraction
CONTACTS · TECH

An autonomous skycab or small aircraft appears at a permitted or improvised outside position: real booking, fake VIP instruction, takeover, rigger or flashback.

Own idea
ALWAYS ALLOWED

If the group finds a plausible better way, let it work.

CONSEQUENCES DURING THE ESCAPE

- The preferred exit is closed.
- An elevator stops on the wrong floor.
- Gear has to be left behind.
- A drone latches onto the crew.
- The group is split up.
- A jump or flight manoeuvre causes harm or loss of equipment.

WHO SHOWS UP AT FULL ALERT?

Deliberately just a **contracted external police provider** or a contractual response team. Whether that is Knight Errant or Lone Star is your call if you want to check it against a Seattle source. With plenty of time left, start a short response clock; otherwise the next big consequence is the arriving reinforcement.

during the escape STEP 9

The reveal

During or right after the escape, not as a long monologue. No final boss, no new confrontation: solely the assessment of the test.

SEE ALSO Veyrath Johnson (A)

A vast shadow glides over the façade. Wings beat in the rain. For a moment a real dragon flies or climbs at a clear distance beside the fleeing crew, far larger than anything they expected. It does not block their way and makes no move to attack. Then the runners hear its voice directly in their minds:

> *“Call me Veyrath. The tower is mine. The vault is mine. And so is the case you have just stolen.”*

That makes it clear: they did not rob a rival. Veyrath himself sent them into his own vault. Depending on how things went, he adds:

Clean run

“You take what you were given and leave what is not yours. Rare. So you are actually good for something.”

Successful but chaotic

“Not elegant. Not quiet. But you are still alive and the case is with you. That will do for now.”

Lots of violence

“Violence is a tool. Whoever uses the same tool for every problem is no craftsman.”

Extra loot

“I asked you for one object. You decided my property should raise your pay. I will remember that.”

Opened case

“Curiosity is valuable. So is discipline. Tonight you showed me which of the two wins with you.”

Charge neutralised cleanly

“Recognising the safeguard was good work. Having to overcome it was your own decision.”

NO FIGHT

Veyrath stays out of reach, does not threaten the crew and does not block their escape. If the runners shoot at him, he ends the contact and withdraws rather than turning the epilogue into a fight against a dragon.

wrap-up STEP 10

Payoff and assessment

The base pay is 6 nuyen. Veyrath ties the actual payout to the crew's professionalism. The calculator on the left applies the rule.

SEE ALSO Cheat sheet Alert, Matrix & payoff | Johnson (A)

ALERT AT THE END	PAYOUT
Low alert (0–1)	6 nuyen
Medium alert (2–5)	5 nuyen
High alert / lockdown (6)	3 nuyen

Injured or dead guests and staff count **at least as high alert** for the payout. Seriously harming or killing Dr. Venn is additionally a clear breach of contract. Damage to the collection weighs even heavier for Veyrath than harm to people: damaged or additionally stolen pieces draw his marked displeasure and can cut the payout further.

Ideal candidates
FOLLOW-UP JOBS

- Case unopened
- No extra loot, collection undamaged
- Venn unharmed
- Little unnecessary violence
- Problems solved creatively and as a team

Usable but risky
MAYBE

- Job done
- Medium or high alert
- Avoidable attention
- Unnecessary but not catastrophic escalation

Not suitable
NO FURTHER CONTACT

- Case opened deliberately, even expertly
- Contents destroyed by careless opening
- Venn seriously harmed or killed
- Collection damaged or extra loot taken
- Indiscriminate killing despite clear orders

This does not mean the characters were "played wrong". It is this employer's reaction to their decisions. Give the crew room at the payoff to react to the reveal.

OPTIONAL: HEAT PER RITS

For a pure one-shot skip this step. If the crew continues, heat is determined by the normal rules, not copied from the alert clock: 0 heat smooth & quiet, 2 contained, 4 loud & chaotic, 6 wild, plus situational modifiers for high-profile targets or killings. **Alert** is what security knows and does now. **Heat** is the long-term attention afterwards.

throughout the run TOOLS

Alert, consequences and pacing

The alert clock replaces heat during the run. It rises when an action plausibly draws attention and can fall when the fiction allows it.

SEE ALSO Cheat sheet Running rolls · Cheat sheet Alert, Matrix & payoff

ALERT CLOCK · 6 SEGMENTS

Routine
0–1

- Anomalies count as normal event deviations
- Drones patrol on standard patterns
- No search for the runners

Suspicion
2–3

- Cameras compare movements and identities more closely
- Single doors ask for credentials again
- Drones watch conspicuous areas
- Staff are quietly questioned

Active alarm
4–5

- Drones search actively
- Service routes partly closed
- Elevators stopped or rerouted
- Guests kept away from endangered areas
- Identified runners are pursued

Lockdown
6

- Alarm counts as confirmed
- Escape routes locked or controlled
- External security or police provider called
- Room to act remains, but clearly escalation

Suspicion means **no automatic dice penalty**. The changed fiction influences position and effect of coming actions. If an action works directly on the clock, limited / standard / great effect maps to 1 / 2 / 3 segments.

When does alert rise?
A FITTING CONSEQUENCE WHEN …

- a camera sees something
- a sensor is triggered
- a false identity is checked
- a drone sends a warning
- a guest raises the alarm
- a door is forced open
- shots or explosions are audible
- a Matrix intrusion leaves a usable trace

Not every failed roll raises alert. Equally possible: harm, lost gear, worse position, less effect, blocked exit, suspicious Venn, keycard moved elsewhere, a drone appears, group split up.

Can alert fall?
TUG-OF-WAR CLOCK

- A runner credibly explains to a guard why the deviation was harmless
- A camera sequence is replaced with older footage
- A triggered sensor is disguised as a fault
- A drone is intercepted before it reports
- A manipulated door log looks like maintenance
- A party incident explains noise or movement

Nobody says “I roll to lower alert”. First it must be clear what the character does in the world. On success alert drops according to effect, or an imminent rise is prevented.

NO HACKER REQUIRED

A hacker has many opportunities to prevent alert but no exclusive right to it. Social: redirect suspicion, keep staff busy. Deception: identity or work order. Physical: disable a sensor or drone before it transmits. Precision: destroy optics and weapon modules. Tech: cables, doors, local controls. Magic: perception or movement. Mobility: leave the area before the search closes in. Repeated hacks do not automatically get harder, only when the fiction gives a reason: a countermeasure is running, a trace has begun, a system was isolated.

SCENARIO-SPECIFIC DRAGON’S DEALS

⚖ The invitation is genuine. But someone at the party recognises your alias.

⚖ You get the perfect biometric scan. Dr. Venn will remember your face very precisely later.

⚖ The drone goes offline at once. Its last data burst, however, has already been sent.

⚖ The maintenance gondola takes you exactly to the target. Then it locks itself outside and is no longer available for the escape.

⚖ You reach the case without further resistance. In return the vault door closes behind you.

SPOTLIGHT FOR THE PLAYBOOKS

PLAYBOOK	TYPICAL CHANCES TO SHINE
Face	Invitation, contacts, a serious collector role, keeping Venn busy, defusing suspicion socially
Hacker	Guest lists, cameras, elevators, access logs, drones, building tech
Muscle	Protecting the group, heavy gear, non-lethal takedowns, forced emergency routes, drones in melee
Punk	Façade infiltration, parkour, distraction, sabotage, chaotic improvisation and escape
Rigger	Pilot for drop or escape, maintenance gondola, building drones, vehicles, remote control
Snake	Staff roles, disguise, deception, keycard theft, manipulating Venn
Trigger	Overwatch, spotting danger early, precisely disabling drone components, securing the exit
Adept	Depending on the way: perception, danger sense, mobility, physical infiltration; with fitting abilities astral problems
Mage	Assense the mana barrier and watcher, magical traces, telling magical objects apart, own workarounds
Techno	Influencing signals and networked systems emergently, manipulating drones or building tech, spotting anomalies

The run is not a character quiz. Nobody gets a room “just for their class”. The actions on the sheet matter more than the label.

PACING

Planning too long?

- Which plan are you using?
- What is the detail?
- Which load do you choose?
- Then engagement roll and cut to the action.

Plenty of time left?

- Play the escape in more detail
- Let a cut-off runner look for an alternative route
- Response clock after full alert
- Give the crew room at the payoff to react to the reveal

for printing APPENDIX

Quick reference

Everything important at a glance when there is no time to flip pages at the table.

SEE ALSO Cheat sheet Core rules · Cheat sheet Which action?

The job

- **Steal:** the black case from the vault, unopened
- **Hidden safeguard:** charge primarily destroys the contents on unauthorised opening; discoverable and defusable
- **Tamper indicator:** opening stays provable even after defusal
- **Do not steal:** anything else · **Do not harm:** Dr. Venn · **Avoid:** deaths
- **Payoff:** 6 nuyen at low alert, 5 at medium, 3 at high; harm to people at least as high

Access factors

- Vault keycard in the black box in the event office (service area)
- Dr. Venn’s eye scan: left, amber, natural eye
- Without one or both factors access remains possible, but louder, riskier, slower

Penthouse 111/112

- Grand salon · exhibition gallery · winter garden
- Service area with event office
- Collector’s lift behind the exhibition rooms
- Private study with private lift
- Glass roof and roof access

Vault level 110

- Shared access airlock
- Sensor corridor
- Drone node: recon and guardians
- Vault door: keycard + eye scan, any order
- Living vault shell with dual mana barrier, optional astral watcher
- Modern dragon hoard with temptation

Alert clock ○○○○○○

- **0–1** routine
- **2–3** suspicion
- **4–5** active alarm
- **6** lockdown + external response

NPCs

- **Mr. Johnson:** Veyrath's professional fixer
- **Dr. Amara Venn:** ork curator, left eye = biometrics, has no keycard
- **Dorian Kade:** head of security, cyberarms, knows storage and release of the keycard
- **Veyrath:** ambitious young dragon, owner and employer, tests the crew, never fights

The truth

- Veyrath owns penthouse, vault, collection and case and commissioned the break-in into his own vault
- No rival dragon
- The gala deliberately creates a realistic window
- Tested: discipline, creativity, teamwork and control of escalation

Dice

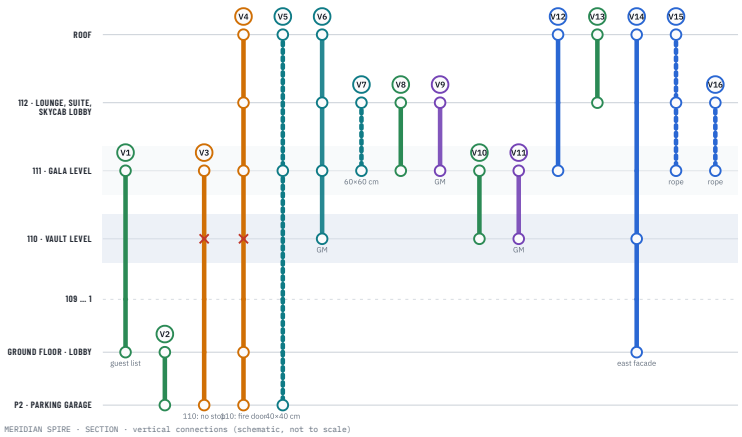
- **6** success · **4/5** with consequence · **1–3** bad · several 6s critical
- Position: controlled / risky / desperate · effect: limited / standard / great
- 2 edge push, 1 edge assist, resistance costs edge
- Flashback 0–2 edge depending on effort

Fan material for the private gaming table. *Runners in the Shadows* is a Forged in the Dark game by Mark Cleveland Massengale; *Shadowrun* is a trademark of The Topps Company / Catalyst Game Labs. Meridian Spire, Vesperline Collections, Dr. Amara Venn, Dorian Kade, Veyrath and the living vault tissue are original creations for this one-shot. Portraits you insert here are stored only in your browser.

Section

All vertical connections at a glance

GM PLAN



NO.	CONNECTION	FROM → TO	WHO	PRICE / RISK
V1	Glass elevator	Ground-floor lobby → 111 foyer	Guests	Invitation; arrival and face are logged
V2	VIP lobby elevator	P2 VIP drop-off → Ground-floor lobby	Guests by car	Appearance; the real check waits upstairs
V3	Freight elevator	P2 freight lobby → 111 core corridor	Staff, crates	Badge + scan; stop at 110 only via Interface or a rigger (shaft door)
V4	Staff stairs	P2 → Roof	Staff, emergencies	Roof door with alarm contact; 110 only during a fire alarm
V5	Drone shaft	P2 depot → 111 kitchen · roof drone port	items only	40×40 cm; a rigger or hacker takes over a delivery drone
V6	Maintenance shaft	Roof shaft head → 110 suppression plant	one person, tight	Inspection door 111, floor hatch 112; motion sensor only on 110
V7	Dumbwaiter	111 kitchen → 112 pantry	items, very slim runners	60×60 cm; desperate for people
V8	Grand staircase	111 salon → 112 lounge	Guests	None, but everyone sees who goes up
V9	Private stairs	112 suite → 111 study	Veyrath	Suite reader, three motion sensors; ends next to the private lift
V10	Collector lift	111 gallery vestibule → 110 airlock	Venn, guard, registered visitors	Reader + registration; the airlock counts people
V11	Private lift	111 study → 110 airlock	Veyrath	Wood panelling; the study has four doors
V12	Access ladder	111 terrace → Roof north edge	Climbers	8 m in the rain, cage locked at the top, camera points elsewhere
V13	Skycab stairs	112 skycab lobby → Roof landing pad	VIPs by air	Booking + badge; approach transponder hackable
V14	Facade gondola	Roof BMU → 110 technical airlock · ground floor	Riggers, technicians	Logged, visible from the east windows; Dragon's Deal: locks itself afterwards
V15	Atrium & glass roofs	Roof maintenance vent → 112 gallery walk · 111 salon or conservatory	Rappelling	Atrium: everyone sees it. Conservatory: quiet, 5 m into plants
V16	South facade	112 sky terrace → 111 private balcony	Rappelling	3 m sideways, 5 m down; motion sensor below

PLAY SITUATIONS

Every level has at least three connections up and down. If a route gets blocked (elevator stopped, door locked), do not show the group the section, but let them ask: "What else is there?" The answer is here.

Two routes carry items only. Drone shaft and dumbwaiter separate gear from people: the crew walks unarmed through the arch, the weapons follow via the kitchen.

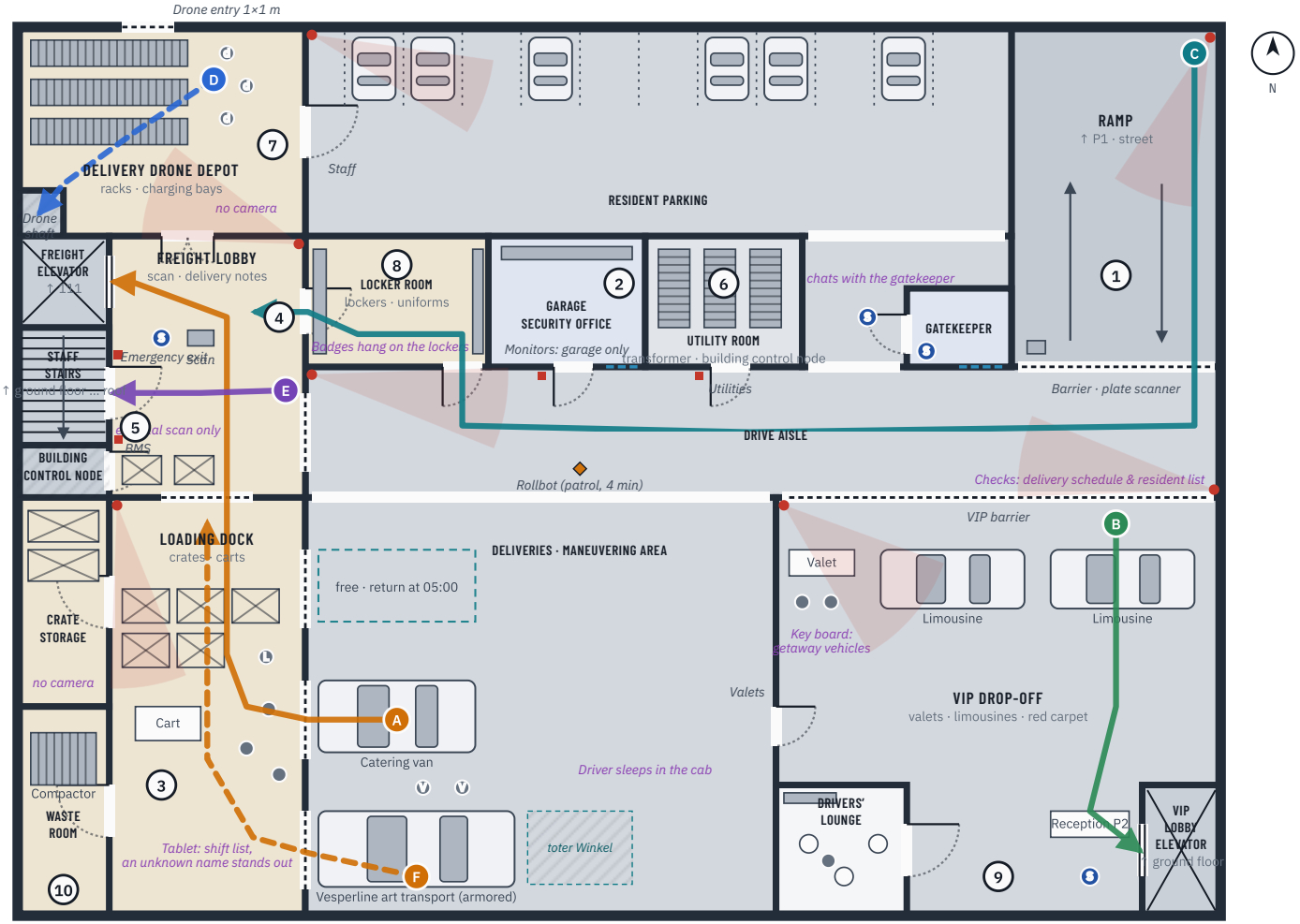
Level 110 is the bottleneck. Only collector lift, private lift, maintenance shaft and gondola reach it regularly; freight elevator and stairs need a trick (Interface, fire alarm). That is exactly why it is the vault.

A split crew. If the group gets separated (consequence), give each part its own vertical route: one in the freight elevator, one on the access ladder, one in the gondola. They meet on 110 from three directions.

Parking garage P2

Deliveries, freight elevator & VIP drop-off (detail)

GM PLAN



MERIDIAN SPIRE · PARKING GARAGE P2 · DELIVERIES (DETAIL) · 1 unit = 1 m · walls schematic

0 m 5 m 10 m

Public / guests · Service / staff · Secured · Private (Veyrath) · Outdoors / terrace · Utilities · Core (elevator, stairs, shaft)
Void / open below · Vault (living tissue) · Door · Door with reader / badge · Mechanical lock · Fire door (opens on fire alarm)
Glass door / window · Roll gate / barrier · Airlock door · Elevator door · Hidden / GM only · Inspection hatch · Stairs (arrow = up)
Elevator · Camera with field of view · Light barrier · Pressure plate · Motion sensor · Security (S) · Dorian Kade (K)
Dr. Amara Venn (V) · Staff · Guests · Recon drone · Guardian drone · Blind spot · Astral watcher (patrol)
Mana barrier / magical aura · Case (target) · Keycard box · As a guest / public · As staff · Technical / covert · Outside / facade / air
Private / hidden · dashed = items only, rappelling or special case

4 security + rollbot · 6 cameras · uniforms: locker room
freight elevator ↑ 111 (no stop at 110)
crates: one person fits · art transport waits until 05:00

LOCATIONS

1. Ramp, barrier & gatekeeper
2. Drive aisle & garage security office
3. Deliveries & loading dock
4. Freight lobby & freight elevator
5. Staff stairs (emergency exit)
6. Utility room / building control node
7. Delivery drone depot & drone shaft
8. Staff locker room
9. VIP drop-off & lobby elevator
10. Crate storage & waste room

ROUTES

- **A** As staff: loading dock → freight lobby → freight elevator
- **B** As a guest: VIP drop-off → lobby elevator → ground floor → glass elevator
- **C** On foot over the ramp → locker room → freight lobby
- **D** Drone shaft (items only)
- **E** Staff stairs → ground-floor lobby
- **F** Up in a crate

Parking garage P2

Deliveries, freight elevator & VIP drop-off (detail) · GM notes

GM PLAN

LOCATIONS

1 Ramp, barrier & gatekeeper

The ramp comes down from P1. Plate scanner, barrier, a bored gatekeeper with the trid running.

> **GM** The scanner matches plates against the delivery schedule and resident list (hacker: enter a vehicle). The gatekeeper waves through anything that "looks like catering". The booth sees the ramp and the east end of the drive aisle, not the deliveries. Walking in over the ramp: nobody asks.

2 Drive aisle & garage security office

Main driveway with two cameras. A rolling security robot patrols. The security office has a window onto the drive aisle.

> **GM** The rollbot runs a 4-minute loop drive aisle ↔ maneuvering area; whoever knows it knows when the deliveries are unwatched. The monitors show only the garage, not the tower. The one guard from the office mostly stands with the gatekeeper.

3 Deliveries & loading dock

Catering unloads, a shift supervisor with a tablet coordinates, Vesperline crates pile up. Three dock gates, one van, one armored art transport.

> **GM** The shift list knows every name; an unknown one stands out ("temp, last minute" is the answer). An empty Vesperline crate holds one person. At 01:30 three crates of "stage equipment" ride the freight elevator to 111. The art transport collects the pieces at 05:00; its driver sleeps in the cab. Blind spot behind the transport.

4 Freight lobby & freight elevator

A guard scans badges, delivery notes and crates. The freight elevator goes up to the penthouse core corridor.

> **GM** Crates are only scanned from the outside (metal and radio stand out; "stage equipment" explains a lot). Level 110 cannot be selected, but the shaft door there exists. The guard changes every two hours; the relief does not know the early shift's faces.

5 Staff stairs (emergency exit)

Escape stairs through the whole building.

> **GM** 111 floors on foot are not an option, but two levels to the ground-floor lobby are: the glass elevator waits there, and staff becomes guests. At the top the stairs end at the roof (alarm contact); they pass 110 with a locked fire door.

6 Utility room / building control node

Locked, sign "Utilities". Transformer, distribution.

> **GM** Physical access to the building automation: elevators, doors, cameras of the garage and the core corridor on 111. A hacker position out of sight. Level 110 has its own host and cannot be reached from here, but the freight elevator can be stopped at 110.

7 Delivery drone depot & drone shaft

Drones hum, charge, launch through an entry opening to the street. A shaft leads upward.

> **GM** The drone shaft (40×40 cm) ends in the kitchen on 111 and at the drone port on the roof. A rigger takes over a delivery drone and sends a weapon, tool or keycard through the building. The drone entry is a way for micro drones past the gatekeeper. No camera.

8 Staff locker room

Lockers, uniforms, a sink.

> **GM** Uniforms of catering and building services, badges hang on the lockers. No camera. Doors to the freight lobby and the drive aisle: the change between guest and staff in both directions.

9 VIP drop-off & lobby elevator

Limousines, valets, a red carpet to the elevator up to the ground floor, where the glass elevator waits. A drivers' lounge with a trid.

> **GM** Invitations are only checked upstairs; here appearance counts. In the drivers' lounge: gossip about guests, about Venn ("the curator with the black eye") and Kade ("the one with the chrome arms sees everything"). Valet key board = getaway vehicles. Camera at the barrier.

10 Crate storage & waste room

Empties, a waste compactor.

> **GM** No camera coverage, a good hiding place. The compactor noise covers a lot. Empty crates disguise gear that should not pass the scan.

ROUTES

A As staff: loading dock → freight lobby → freight elevator

Uniform, crate, delivery note. The scan checks badge and load, not faces. Ends in the core corridor on 111.

B As a guest: VIP drop-off → lobby elevator → ground floor → glass elevator

Appearance instead of ID. The real check waits upstairs in the foyer.

C On foot over the ramp → locker room → freight lobby

Nobody questions pedestrians. In the locker room the stranger becomes staff; door 2 leads straight to the guard with the scanner.

D Drone shaft (items only)

A rigger or hacker sends gear to the kitchen on 111 or the roof. None of it passes the scan.

E Staff stairs → ground-floor lobby

Two levels up, then switch to the glass elevator. The quiet way when the garage gets too hot.

F Up in a crate

Crates ride at 01:30 or 05:00. Whoever sits inside arrives unscanned in the core corridor. Tight, blind, desperate if checked.

PLAY SITUATIONS

Unloading under pressure. The catering van has to clear the dock in ten minutes. Whoever lends a hand is not asked who they are.

Wrong name. The shift supervisor scans her tablet: "You are not on here." Sway or Deception: "Temp, last minute." On a 4/5 she calls the caterer, who is not reachable right now. Ten minutes' grace.

Crate goes up. At 01:30 three crates of "stage equipment" ride to 111. Whoever sits inside arrives in the core corridor. Crates are only scanned from the outside.

Rollbot. Four-minute loop. Whoever knows the rhythm has two minutes of unwatched maneuvering area.

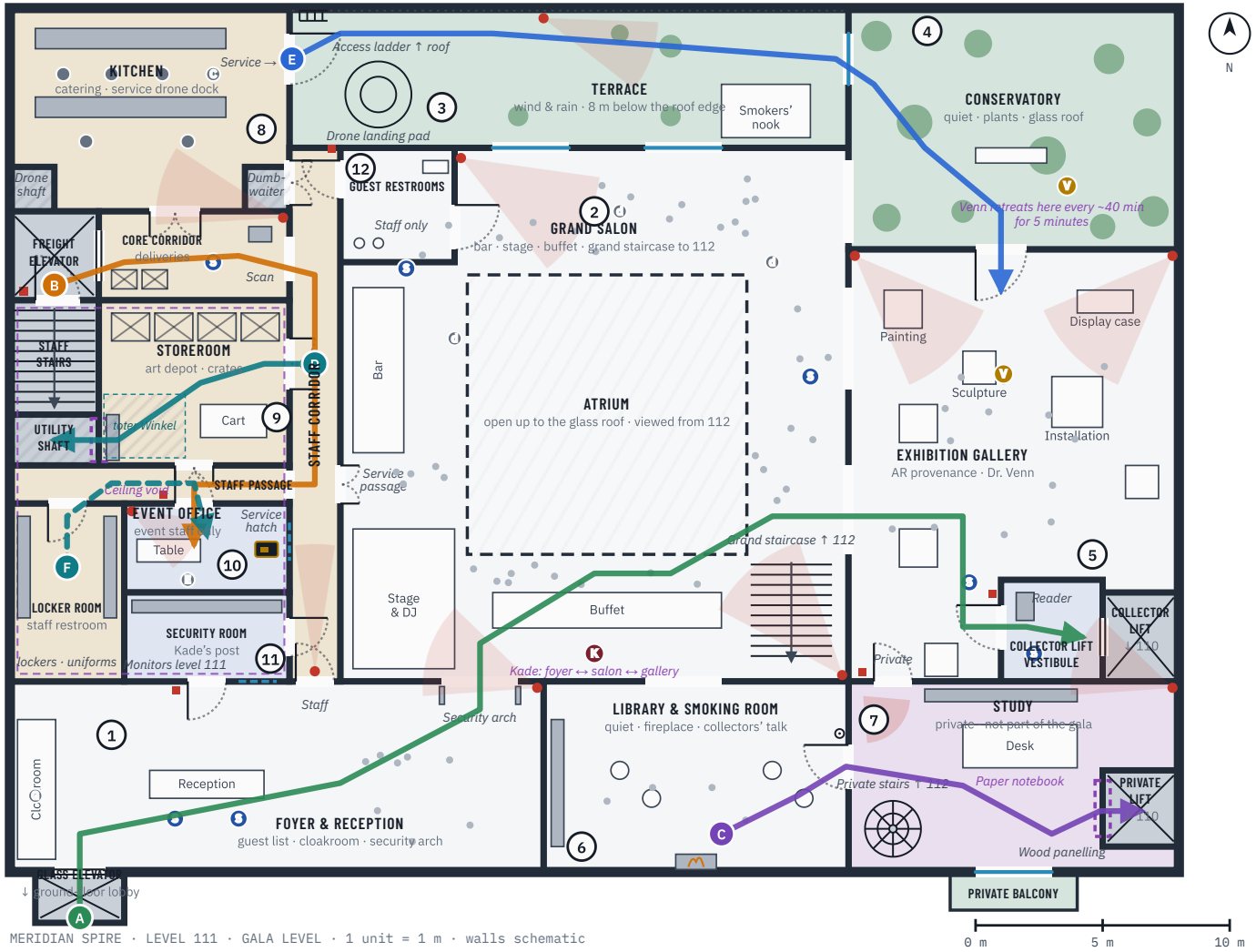
Getaway vehicle. Valet key board, armored art transport with a sleeping driver, limousines with drivers in the lounge. Three options, three volume levels.

Hacker in the basement. From the building control node: elevators, doors, garage cameras. Not level 110. But stopping the freight elevator at 110, that works.

Level 111 Penthouse · gala level

GM PLAN

~80 guests | 7 security + Kade | 9 cameras | 6 service drones | keycard: event office | Venn: gallery ⇔ conservatory



MERIDIAN SPIRE · LEVEL 111 · GALA LEVEL · 1 unit = 1 m · walls schematic

LOCATIONS

1. Glass elevator, foyer & reception
2. Grand Salon & atrium
3. Terrace
4. Conservatory
5. Exhibition gallery & collector lift
6. Library & smoking room
7. Study (private)
8. Kitchen & core corridor
9. Storeroom / art depot
10. Event office
11. Security room
12. Guest restrooms

ROUTES

- **A** As a guest to the collector lift
- **B** As staff to the keycard
- **C** Library → study → private lift
- **D** Storeroom → maintenance shaft → 110
- **E** Around the outside: kitchen → terrace → conservatory → gallery
- **F** Ceiling void → event office

Public / guests · Service / staff · Secured · Private (Veyrath) · Outdoors / terrace · Utilities · Core (elevator, stairs, shaft)
Void / open below · Vault (living tissue) · Door · Door with reader / badge · Mechanical lock · Fire door (opens on fire alarm)
Glass door / window · Roll gate / barrier · Airlock door · Elevator door · Hidden / GM only · Inspection hatch · Stairs (arrow = up)
Elevator · Camera with field of view · Light barrier · Pressure plate · Motion sensor · Security (S) · Dorian Kade (K)
Dr. Amara Venn (V) · Staff · Guests · Recon drone · Guardian drone · Blind spot · Astral watcher (patrol)
Mana barrier / magical aura · Case (target) · Keycard box · As a guest / public · As staff · Technical / covert · Outside / facade / air
Private / hidden · dashed = items only, rappelling or special case

Level 111

Penthouse · gala level · GM notes

GM PLAN

LOCATIONS

1 Glass elevator, foyer & reception

The glass elevator rides up the outside of the facade and opens straight into the foyer. Two security staff check the guest list, the cloakroom takes coats and bags, an unobtrusive arch stands at the transition to the salon.

> GM The arch detects weapons and heavy cyberware but only reports silently to Kade: conspicuous guests are not stopped but watched (Alert +1, one guard stays in view). The cloakroom is the perfect stash for a flashback ("the bag has been hanging here since 9 pm"). The elevator log stores arrival time and face.

2 Grand Salon & atrium

The social heart: ~50 guests, bar, stage, buffet, service drones with drinks. Above the atrium the room opens up to the glass roof; the grand staircase leads to the VIP lounge on 112.

> GM The crowd is cover, but two cameras see almost everything. Service drones can be hijacked (distraction: a tray drops; transport: a keycard or commlink travels across the room). Anyone standing on the glass roof throws a silhouette over the party during lightning. Two security staff; Kade makes his rounds foyer → salon → gallery.

3 Terrace

Open to the sky, wind and rain. To the west the landing pad of the service drones, to the east a covered smokers' nook. Doors to the kitchen, the salon and the conservatory.

> GM Only one camera, pointed at the landing pad; the smokers' nook is unwatched. The service door to the kitchen is often left ajar (staff smoke here). Access ladder to the roof: cage locked at the top, climbable around the outside (Prowl, risky). The terrace is the bypass around the party: kitchen → terrace → conservatory → gallery.

4 Conservatory

A quiet retreat with living plants and its own glass roof. Dr. Venn escapes the small talk here.

> GM No camera ("guest privacy"). Venn is alone here for about 5 minutes every ~40 minutes: the best spot for a high-resolution iris capture or a serious conversation about art. The glass roof above is the quieter roof entry (see roof ⑥).

5 Exhibition gallery & collector lift

Eight pieces on plinths, AR overlays with provenance and price. Dr. Venn gladly explains details to anyone seriously interested. At the back the vestibule to the collector lift: reader, one guard.

> GM Every ~40 minutes a piece is taken back down to 110: Venn, one guard and a transport cart ride the collector lift (a lift to hitch, a crate, a logistics disguise). For that, Kade's clearance fetches the keycard from the event office: it is then out of the box for 10 minutes. The reader demands a security badge or Venn's registration. Two cameras.

6 Library & smoking room

Leather, fireplace, few guests, hushed conversation. This is where the serious collectors sit.

> GM No camera. The door to the study has a mechanical lock (not hackable, but lockpicks or force work). Guests here know things: who Venn is, that Kade "with the chrome arms" sees everything, that the gala ends at 3 am.

7 Study (private)

Locked, sign "Private". Not part of the event.

> GM Four entrances: gallery door (reader + alarm contact), library door (mechanical), private stairs from the suite on 112, private balcony (facade, rappel from the sky terrace 112). Motion sensor + camera. Behind the flush wood panelling lies the private lift to 110 (finger-wide gap, warm draft). On the desk a paper notebook in the same handwriting as Mr. Johnson's notes.

8 Kitchen & core corridor

Catering in full swing, service drones dock. The freight elevator and deliveries arrive in the core corridor; a guard scans delivery notes and crates.

> GM The scan checks badge and load list but opens no crates (metal and radio stand out; "stage equipment" explains a lot). Drone shaft 40×40 cm: garage ↔ kitchen ↔ roof, have gear delivered in portions. Dumbwaiter 60×60 cm to the pantry on 112. The head chef remembers unfamiliar faces, not uniforms.

9 Storeroom / art depot

Vesperline transport crates, tools, an art transport cart.

> GM An empty crate holds one person. Blind spot behind the crates. Behind a shelf the inspection door to the utility shaft: inside, the maintenance shaft with a ladder down to 110 (suppression plant) and up to the roof. Motion sensor only on 110.

10 Event office

Small office, door "Event staff only", a service hatch to the staff corridor.

> GM The keycard lies in the black box; removal only with Kade's clearance, everything is logged. The event manager drops by every ~15 minutes. Camera inside. The suspended ceiling connects locker room, staff passage, storeroom and office (ceiling void, barely carries one person). At the hatch, anyone who plausibly cites Kade's clearance gets the card handed over the counter.

11 Security room

Kade's post: monitor wall, radio, doors to the foyer and the staff corridor.

> GM Kade is away 60 % of the time. Monitors show all cameras of this level, not those of 110 (separate system). Anyone standing here can lower Alert: swap footage, mark a sensor as defective. The window to the foyer is mirrored glass.

12 Guest restrooms

Vestibule with mirrors, stalls behind. In the vestibule a door "Staff only".

> GM The staff door leads into the staff corridor, simple cylinder lock. Classic role change: in as a guest, out as staff (uniform from the locker room opposite). No camera in the restrooms.

ROUTES

A As a guest to the collector lift

Glass elevator → foyer → arch → salon → gallery → vestibule. Needs an invitation; at the vestibule a badge or Venn's registration.

B As staff to the keycard

Freight elevator → core corridor (scan) → staff corridor → staff passage → event office (badge reader). Uniform + a reason to be in the office.

C Library → study → private lift

Mechanical lock, motion sensor, wood panelling. Quiet, no reader log, but the alarm contact on the gallery door stays untouched.

D Storeroom → maintenance shaft → 110

Inspection door behind the shelf, narrow shaft with a ladder. No staff, but a motion sensor at the exit on 110.

E Around the outside: kitchen → terrace → conservatory → gallery

Bypasses salon and arch. Wind, rain, one camera at the landing pad. Ends right next to Venn.

F Ceiling void → event office

Crawl from the locker room or storeroom over the partition wall. Barely carries one person; the office camera points downward.

PLAY SITUATIONS

Return transport. Every ~40 minutes a piece goes back to 110: Venn, a guard, a transport cart. For that the keycard leaves its box for 10 minutes and travels core corridor → gallery → vestibule. Both factors are briefly in the same place.

Silent check. The arch only reports to Kade. Anyone conspicuous gets no scene, just a shadow. Attentive runners notice: the same guard is always within sight.

Venn alone. In the conservatory without a camera, five minutes. Iris capture, honest conversation, invitation to a private viewing: this is where it is decided whether the biometric factor is solved socially or technically.

Four doors into the study. Reader (hacker), mechanical (snake/punk), stairs from above (prowl), balcony (rigger/adept). Every crew finds its own.

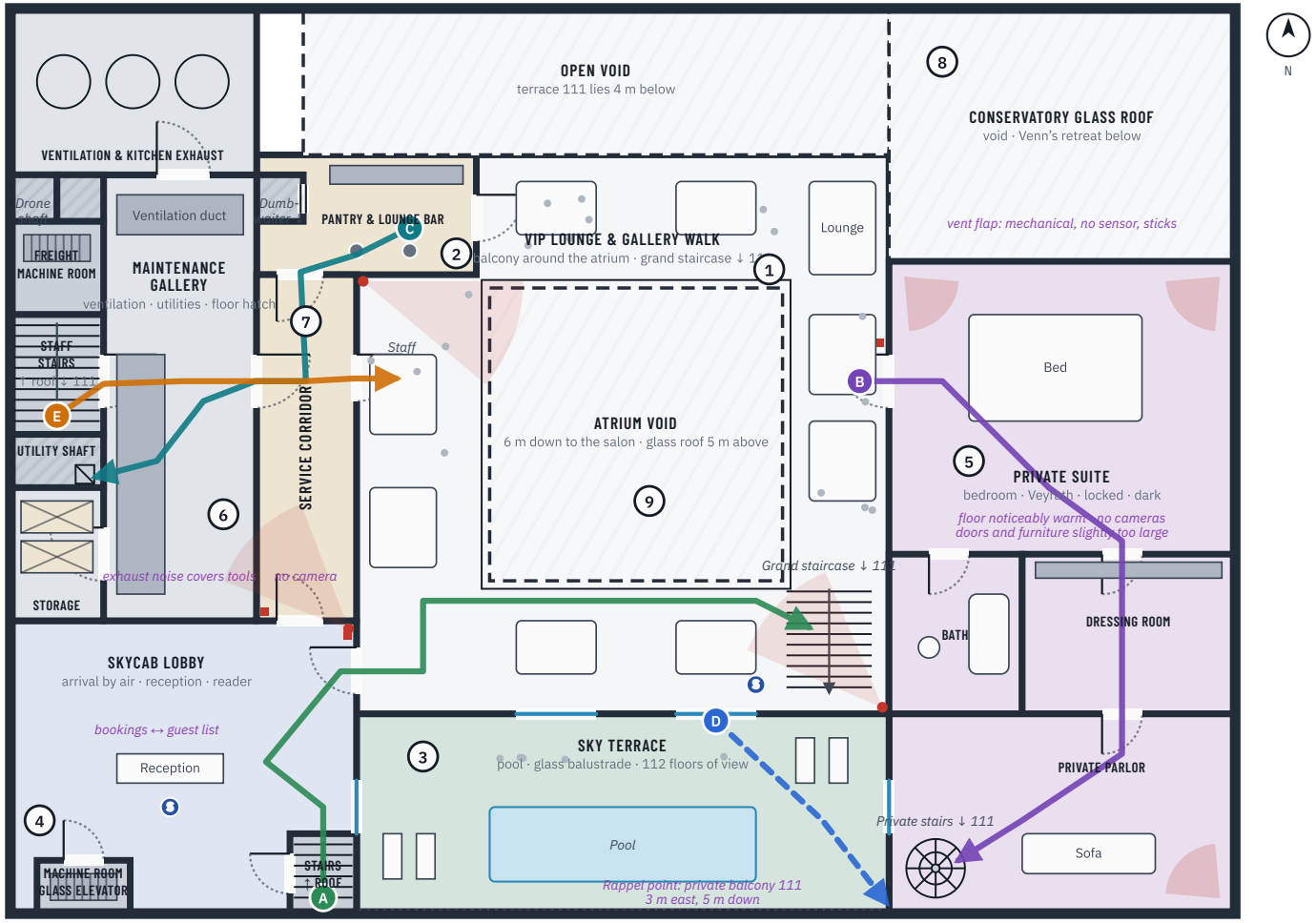
Role change in the restroom. In as a guest, out through the staff door. The locker room with uniforms is right opposite.

Service hatch. A runner in security uniform demands the card "on Kade's orders for the return transport". Sway or Command, risky. On a 4/5 the event manager calls Kade to confirm.

Level 112

Penthouse · VIP lounge, suite & skycab lobby

GM PLAN



MERIDIAN SPIRE · LEVEL 112 · UPPER PENTHOUSE LEVEL · 1 unit = 1 m · walls schematic

0 m — 5 m — 10 m

Public / guests · Service / staff · Secured · Private (Veyrath) · Outdoors / terrace · Utilities · Core (elevator, stairs, shaft)

Void / open below · Vault (living tissue) · Door · Door with reader / badge · Mechanical lock · Fire door (opens on fire alarm)

Glass door / window · Roll gate / barrier · Airlock door · Elevator door · Hidden / GM only · Inspection hatch · Stairs (arrow = up)

Elevator · Camera with field of view · Light barrier · Pressure plate · Motion sensor · Security (S) · Dorian Kade (K)

Dr. Amara Venn (V) · Staff · Guests · Recon drone · Guardian drone · Blind spot · Astral watcher (patrol)

Mana barrier / magical aura · Case (target) · Keycard box · As a guest / public · As staff · Technical / covert · Outside / facade / air

Private / hidden · dashed = items only, rappelling or special case

~15 VIP guests · 2 security · 2 cameras · suite: empty, motion sensors · skycab lobby checks bookings · dumbwaiter ↔ kitchen 111

LOCATIONS

1. VIP lounge & gallery walk
2. Pantry & dumbwaiter
3. Sky terrace & pool
4. Skycab lobby
5. Private suite
6. Maintenance gallery & utilities
7. Service corridor
8. Conservatory glass roof (void)
9. Atrium void

ROUTES

- **A** By skycab into the party
- **B** Lounge → suite → private stairs → study
- **C** Pantry → service corridor → maintenance gallery → floor hatch
- **D** Sky terrace → rappel to the private balcony 111
- **E** Staff stairs → service corridor → lounge

Level 112

Penthouse · VIP lounge, suite & skycab lobby · GM notes

GM PLAN

LOCATIONS

1 VIP lounge & gallery walk

A balcony runs around the atrium. Few, very well-connected guests, lounge furniture, the grand staircase down into the salon. From the railing you see the whole party.

> GM Fewer guests means more attention per person: anyone who does not belong stands out within minutes. One security officer, two cameras. The railing is overwatch for a trigger and the fastest way down (rope into the atrium, 6 m). Service drones fly through the void.

2 Pantry & dumbwaiter

A small bar kitchen for the lounge; supplies come up by dumbwaiter from the kitchen on 111.

> GM Dumbwaiter 60×60 cm: items, a keycard handover between two runners on different levels, at a pinch a very slim runner (desperate). Two service staff who rarely look up.

3 Sky terrace & pool

Outdoor terrace with heated pool, glass balustrade, wind. Doors to the lounge, the skycab lobby and the suite.

> GM No camera except the one at the lobby door. The balustrade is a rappel point to the private balcony 111 (3 m east, 5 m down) and the escape route for anything that flies. The facade gondola passes along the east edge. The suite door is locked, but glass.

4 Skycab lobby

Arrival for guests who come by skycab: reception, reader, stairs to the landing pad on the roof.

> GM One security officer checks skycab bookings against the guest list; anyone with a booking entered counts as expected. The reader to the lounge needs the guest badge. Escape route number one at low Alert: order a skycab, up the stairs, gone. Camera above the door.

5 Private suite

Locked, dark, not part of the gala.

> GM Empty. Motion sensors in three corners, no cameras (Veyrath tolerates none in his rooms). The private stairs in the parlor lead directly into the study on 111: the way to the private lift that bypasses gallery and library entirely. Hints about the owner: warm floor, oversized doors and furniture, tailored suits without labels in the dressing room.

6 Maintenance gallery & utilities

Ventilation plant, ducts, staff stairs, a storage room with furniture. Loud.

> GM Floor hatch into the utility shaft: the maintenance shaft leads down to the storeroom on 111 and on to the suppression plant on 110, up to the roof. The staff stairs continue to the roof (door with alarm contact). The exhaust noise covers tool sounds.

7 Service corridor

Staff connection between pantry and skycab lobby.

> GM No camera. Service staff and VIP reception cross paths here: the best place to swap a uniform for a suit or the other way round.

8 Conservatory glass roof (void)

From here you look down through the glass into the conservatory.

> GM From the roof: vent flap for ventilation, mechanical, no sensor, sticks (Prowl or Engineer, controlled when calm). Below, Venn's camera-free retreat. 5 m of rappelling into plants.

9 Atrium void

A view 6 m down onto the party, 5 m up to the glass roof.

> GM Fall hazard for consequences. A rope from the railing is the fastest way down and up (glass roof maintenance vent). Anyone hanging here is seen.

ROUTES

A By skycab into the party

Landing pad → stairs → skycab lobby (booking + badge) → lounge → grand staircase → salon. In reverse the most elegant escape.

B Lounge → suite → private stairs → study

Reader on the suite door, three motion sensors, nothing else. Ends right next to the private lift, without gallery and library.

C Pantry → service corridor → maintenance gallery → floor hatch

Camera-free all the way to the shaft. Down to the storeroom on 111 or all the way to 110.

D Sky terrace → rappel to the private balcony 111

Wind, rain, glass. Prowl, risky. Below, the motion sensor in the study is waiting.

E Staff stairs → service corridor → lounge

The service staff's route: coming from 111 or the roof, into the lounge without a reader.

PLAY SITUATIONS

Who belongs here? In the VIP lounge everyone knows everyone. An unfamiliar face is addressed, not reported: "And you are here with whom?" A face shines, a muscle sweats.

Skycab booking. A hacker enters a booking into the arrival system before the run. Then the lobby guard expects guests, not intruders. Without a booking: a polite query, Alert +1.

The suite smells of dragon. Whoever gets in finds nothing useful but many hints: warm floor, huge bed, tailored suits. A mage senses an old, calm presence. No alarm, but a hunch.

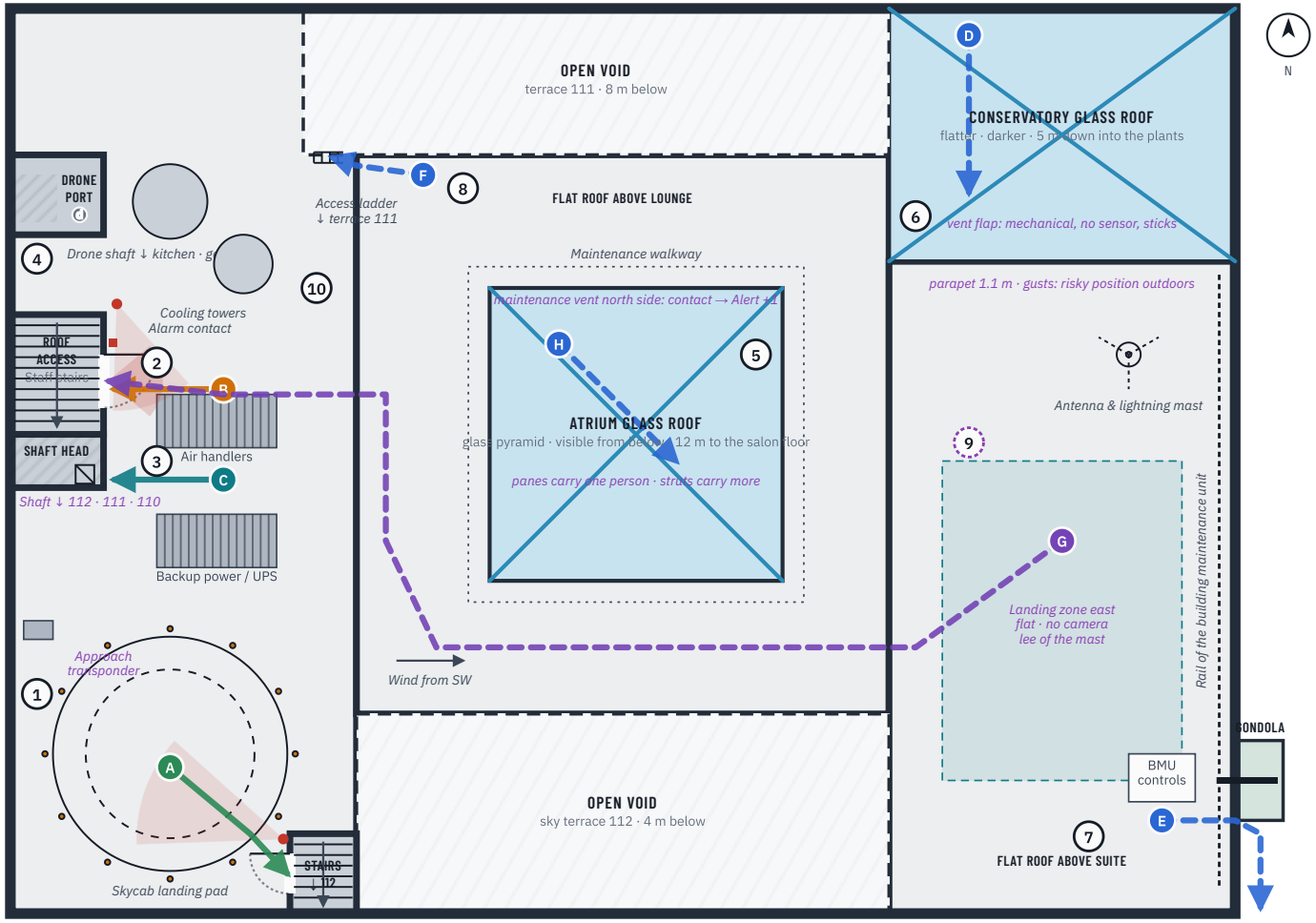
From top to bottom. Four ways from 112 to 111: grand staircase (public), private stairs (hidden), staff stairs (staff), rope into the atrium (spectacular).

Pool party. A consequence on the sky terrace: someone falls into the pool, everyone looks. Two minutes in which nobody watches the lounge.

Roof

Landing pad, glass roofs, gondola & three ways down

GM PLAN



MERIDIAN SPIRE · ROOF · 112 FLOORS ABOVE SEATTLE · 1 unit = 1 m · walls schematic

0 m 5 m 10 m

Public / guests · Service / staff · Secured · Private (Veyrath) · Outdoors / terrace · Utilities · Core (elevator, stairs, shaft)
Void / open below · Vault (living tissue) · Door · Door with reader / badge · Mechanical lock · Fire door (opens on fire alarm)
Glass door / window · Roll gate / barrier · Airlock door · Elevator door · Hidden / GM only · Inspection hatch · Stairs (arrow = up)
Elevator · Camera with field of view · Light barrier · Pressure plate · Motion sensor · Security (S) · Dorian Kade (K)
Dr. Amara Venn (V) · Staff · Guests · Recon drone · Guardian drone · Blind spot · Astral watcher (patrol)
Mana barrier / magical aura · Case (target) · Keycard box · As a guest / public · As staff · Technical / covert · Outside / facade / air
Private / hidden · dashed = items only, rappelling or special case

2 cameras · wind & rain: risky outdoors · skycab pad with transponder · gondola parked (east facade) · 3 vertical ways down · 2 glass roofs

LOCATIONS

1. Skycab landing pad
2. Roof access, staff stairs
3. Utility shaft head
4. Drone port
5. Atrium glass roof
6. Conservatory glass roof
7. Building maintenance unit (gondola)
8. Access ladder
9. Landing zone east
10. Plant rooms

ROUTES

- A Skycab pad → stairs → lobby 112
- B Roof access → staff stairs
- C Shaft head → maintenance shaft
- D Conservatory glass roof → conservatory 111
- E Gondola → technical airlock 110
- F Access ladder → terrace 111
- G Landing zone east → around the pyramid → roof access
- H Atrium glass roof → salon

Roof

Landing pad, glass roofs, gondola & three ways down · GM notes

GM PLAN

LOCATIONS

1 Skycab landing pad

Lit platform with a shelter and stairs down to the skycab lobby on 112. At night autonomous skycabs land here with VIP guests.

> **GM** The approach transponder grants autonomous skycabs landing clearance: hacked, every cab lands as a "registered arrival"; without clearance it circles for 90 seconds and calls in (Alert +1). Camera at the shelter. Landing zone B for parachutes: flat, but brightly lit.

2 Roof access, staff stairs

The only regular way onto the roof: steel door, reader.

> **GM** Alarm contact: opening without a badge reports silently (Alert +1). Camera and motion sensor in front. The stairs lead down to P2: 112 maintenance gallery, 111 core corridor, past 110 (locked fire door), ground-floor lobby, garage.

3 Utility shaft head

An inconspicuous hatch between the plant rooms.

> **GM** Below it the maintenance shaft (80×80 cm) with a ladder: exits on 112 (floor hatch, maintenance gallery), 111 (inspection door, storeroom) and 110 (suppression plant). No sensor until 110. The most direct way from the roof to the vault without touching the party.

4 Drone port

Delivery drones land here and disappear into a shaft into the building.

> **GM** Drone shaft 40×40 cm down to the kitchen on 111 and on to the garage. A rigger sends gear down or up in portions. The constant drone traffic covers small flying devices of your own. No camera.

5 Atrium glass roof

A lit glass pyramid above the salon. From below every silhouette on the glass is visible.

> **GM** Struts carry, panes carry one person. Maintenance vent on the north side with a contact. Anyone standing here is seen from below during lightning (consequence: a guest points up). Rappelling: 12 m to the salon floor. A fall through the glass is a possible consequence, never the automatic result.

6 Conservatory glass roof

A flatter, dark glass roof above the conservatory.

> **GM** Vent flap mechanical, no sensor, sticks (Prowl/Engineer). Below, Venn's retreat without a camera, 5 m of rappelling into soft plants. The quiet roof entry.

7 Building maintenance unit (gondola)

Maintenance crane with a cleaning gondola, parked at the east edge. Runs on a rail along the facade.

> **GM** Controls manual at the box or via Interface. The gondola runs along the east facade down to the technical airlock on 110 (docking point) and on to the ground floor. Rides are logged; deviation from the maintenance schedule → silent check. Dragon's Deal: "It takes you exactly to the target and then locks itself to the outside."

8 Access ladder

Maintenance ladder at the north edge, down to the terrace on 111.

> **GM** 8 m, cage locked at the top, climbable around the outside. The terrace camera only sees the drone landing pad, not the ladder. Whoever arrives here stands right next to the kitchen service door left ajar.

9 Landing zone east

> **GM** Flat roof above the suite, no camera, lee of the mast. The best drop point for parachute or glider. Caution: parapet only 1.1 m, gusts. From here on foot around the glass pyramid to the roof access.

10 Plant rooms

Cooling towers, air handlers, backup power. Loud, warm, steaming.

> **GM** Cover and noise. Sabotaging backup power/UPS triggers emergency lighting and the lockdown protocol (Alert +2): a bad idea as an entry, a good distraction for the escape.

ROUTES

A Skycab pad → stairs → lobby 112

The official way. Welcomed warmly with a booking, politely questioned without one.

B Roof access → staff stairs

Reader + alarm contact + camera. Leads to 112, 111 and beyond. The route security expects.

C Shaft head → maintenance shaft

Tight, dark, no sensor until 110. Exits on 112, 111, 110. The way around the party.

D Conservatory glass roof → conservatory 111

Flap sticks, no sensor, 5 m of rope into plants. Venn below without a camera.

E Gondola → technical airlock 110

Down the outside of the facade. Logged, visible to guests at the east windows, but it bypasses the whole penthouse.

F Access ladder → terrace 111

8 m of ladder in the rain. Lands next to the kitchen door.

G Landing zone east → around the pyramid → roof access

On foot across the roof: lee first, then open. The camera at the roof access sees you coming.

H Atrium glass roof → salon

Spectacular: maintenance vent, 12 m of rope into the middle of the party. Everyone sees it. Only at full Alert or as a grand entrance.

PLAY SITUATIONS

Approach without clearance. The skycab circles, building security asks questions. With hacked clearance the lobby guard expects "guests" and holds the door.

Silhouettes. Lightning over Seattle. Anyone standing on the atrium glass is seen from below: "a guest points up" is the consequence, not an alarm right away.

Gust. On a 4/5 outdoors: gear slides toward the parapet, the glider snags on the mast, the gondola sways. Harm or lost equipment instead of Alert.

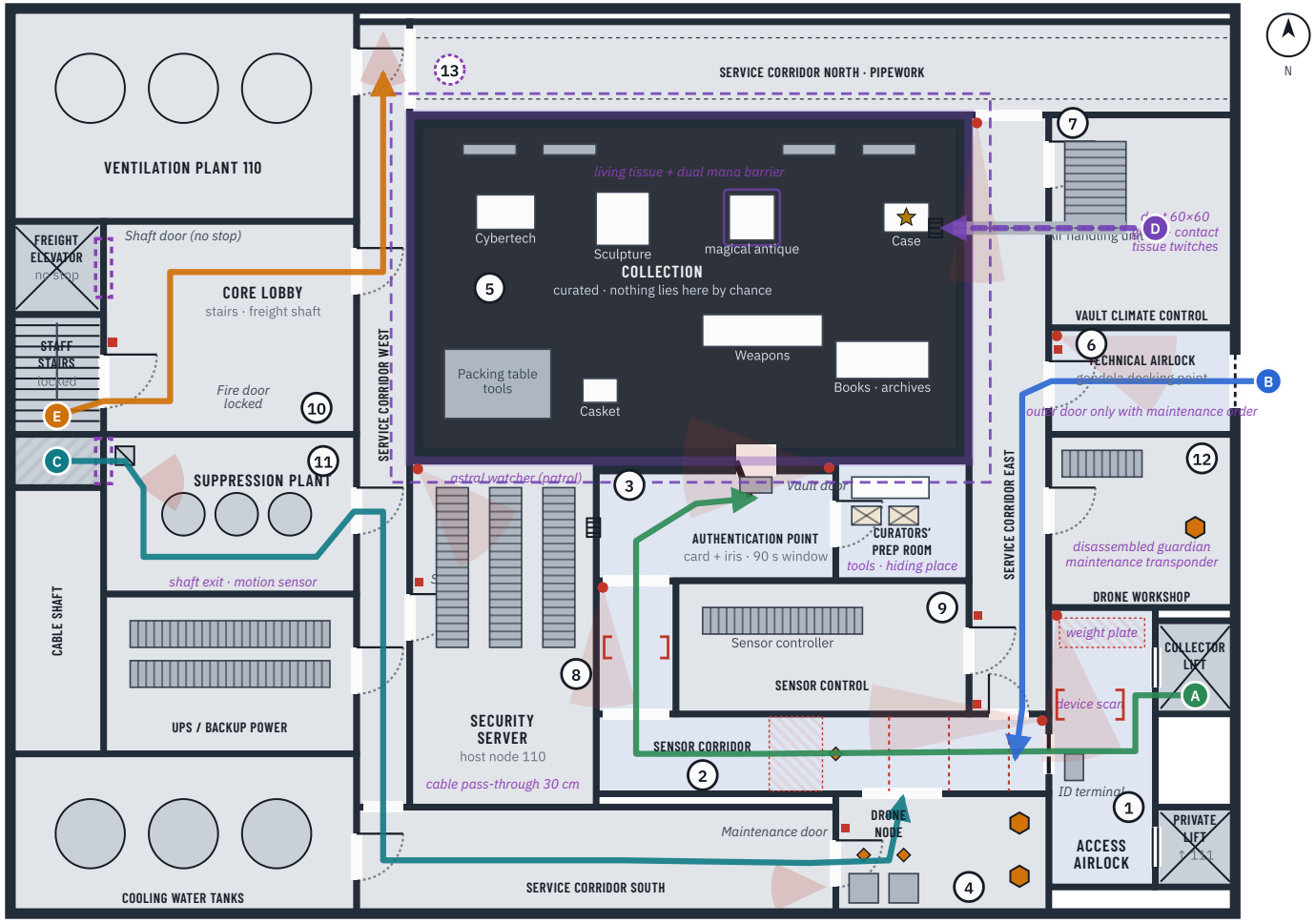
The gondola runs only once. Dragon's Deal: exactly to the target, then it locks itself to the outside of the building. The crew needs something else for the escape.

Three ways down. Stairs (alarm contact, camera), maintenance shaft (tight, sensor only on 110), ladder (terrace, kitchen door). The choice decides where the crew arrives and who sees them.

Level 110

Vault level · officially a “technical floor”

GM PLAN



MERIDIAN SPIRE · LEVEL 110 · VAULT LEVEL · 1 unit = 1 m · walls schematic

Public / guests · Service / staff · Secured · Private (Veyrath) · Outdoors / terrace · Utilities · Core (elevator, stairs, shaft)
Void / open below · Vault (living tissue) · Door · Door with reader / badge · Mechanical lock · Fire door (opens on fire alarm)
Glass door / window · Roll gate / barrier · Airlock door · Elevator door · Hidden / GM only · Inspection hatch · Stairs (arrow = up)
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Private / hidden · dashed = items only, rappelling or special case

no staff · 2 recon + 2 guardian drones · 3 light barriers · pressure plates · RFID · door: card + iris, 90 s window · mana barrier + watcher · 5 ways in

LOCATIONS

1. Access airlock
2. Sensor corridor
3. Authentication point & vault door
4. Drone node
5. Collection (vault)
6. Technical airlock (gondola)
7. Climate control & ventilation duct
8. Security server / host node
9. Sensor control
10. Core lobby, freight shaft & staff stairs
11. Suppression plant
12. Drone workshop
13. Astral watcher & mana barrier

ROUTES

- **A** Regular: lift → airlock → corridor → vault door
- **B** Gondola → technical airlock → east service corridor → maintenance door
- **C** Maintenance shaft → suppression plant → service ring → drone node (rear)
- **D** Climate control → ventilation duct → collection
- **E** Fire alarm: staff stairs → core lobby → service ring

Level 110

Vault level · officially a “technical floor” · GM notes

GM PLAN

LOCATIONS

1 Access airlock

Both lifts end in the same matte-black airlock. Sensors register movement, weight and devices. A terminal asks for identity.

GM The weight plate counts people and compares with the registration. The device scan flags radio and metal. A camera with face matching recognizes Venn and greets her by name. Deviation → silent alarm, the airlock door locks behind the crew (a consequence, not a dead end: the door opens from inside with Engineer or force).

2 Sensor corridor

A long, surprisingly empty corridor. Museum lighting, then a turn to the north.

GM Three light barriers (x positions marked), pressure plates before the turn, RFID arch in the turn, three cameras. During an “authorized viewing” everything stays armed, but the judgement is kinder: position controlled instead of risky. Foam nozzles in the ceiling flood the corridor on alarm (vision and movement impaired, drone sensors too). A recon drone patrols here.

3 Authentication point & vault door

A console with card reader and iris scanner in front of a massive door.

GM Order does not matter, 90-second window. With only one factor: “BIOMETRIC FACTOR: CONFIRMED · PHYSICAL FACTOR: PENDING”. Every attempt is logged. Without factors: 40 cm of composite, tissue and barrier, so loud, long or magically demanding, never impossible. The curators’ prep room next door is a hiding place with tools.

4 Drone node

A side niche with charging bays. It hums.

GM Two recon drones, two guardians. Three states: routine (patrol), viewing (escort, count), irregularity (block, separate, only then weapons). The maintenance ports are an Interface point. The maintenance door at the back leads to the south service corridor: the back entrance into the corridor, right through the nest.

5 Collection (vault)

GM Walls of living tissue carrying a dual mana barrier (reacts to drilling and shock, heals small wounds, densifies on alarm). The case lies on a low plinth at the very back: the way there passes the jewel casket right next to the door, the cybertech and the magical antique. Packing table with tools and packaging. Ventilation grille inside on the east wall.

6 Technical airlock (gondola)

Visible from outside as the facade gondola’s docking point.

GM The outer door opens only with a maintenance order in the system (Interface or forged order) or with force (loud). Camera inside. From here: east service corridor → maintenance door into the corridor (alarm contact) or climate control → ventilation duct.

7 Climate control & ventilation duct

GM The duct (60×60 cm) leads through the east wall into the collection. Grille with contact and vibration sensor; the tissue grows around the duct and twitches when cut (Alert +1, visible trace). The barrier closes the duct astrally. A reported climate fault at the “sensitive object” is the perfect pretext to lure Venn to the airlock.

8 Security server / host node

GM Physical access to doors, sensors and drone logic of this level (not 111, separate system). Cable pass-through 30 cm to the authentication room: a micro drone or a cable fits. Interface here is controlled, but every login is logged: no Alert now, Heat later.

9 Sensor control

GM Local controller of the corridor sensors. Anyone standing here can mark sensors as “under maintenance” (Engineer or Interface): corridor blind for five minutes. Door with reader from the east service corridor.

10 Core lobby, freight shaft & staff stairs

The staff stairs pass this level; the fire door is locked.

GM The freight elevator does not stop here, but the shaft door exists: stop the cab on 110 via Interface or a rigger, open the door manually. The fire door unlocks during a fire alarm (Alert +2, guests are evacuated, but chaos is cover). Utility shaft: maintenance shaft exit into the suppression plant, motion sensor there.

11 Suppression plant

GM Stock of the security foam for the corridor. Whoever controls the plant releases the foam or prevents it. Exit of the maintenance shaft with a motion sensor.

12 Drone workshop

GM Spare parts, a disassembled guardian, maintenance transponders: drones ignore whatever broadcasts as a “maintenance device” (spoofing target recognition, Engineer or Interface). Tools for everything that was missing upstairs.

13 Astral watcher & mana barrier

GM The watcher patrols astrally around the vault (violet loop), reports unusual astral activity (Alert +1) and does not fight. At the doorway the barrier is opened in a controlled way: a mage can study the mechanism with Assense and gain an advantage for a route of their own.

ROUTES

A Regular: lift → airlock → corridor → vault door

The intended way with both factors. With Venn and a registration controlled, as an intruder risky to desperate.

B Gondola → technical airlock → east service corridor → maintenance door

Bypasses airlock and lifts, ends in the corridor behind the light barriers. Alarm contact on the maintenance door.

C Maintenance shaft → suppression plant → service ring → drone node (rear)

Long, dark, no cameras in the ring. Ends in the middle of the drone nest; on routine the drones sleep at their docks.

D Climate control → ventilation duct → collection

60×60 cm, grille with contact, the tissue twitches. Bypasses the vault door completely, but not the barrier (closed astrally).

E Fire alarm: staff stairs → core lobby → service ring

The fire door only unlocks on alarm. Loud, but the chaos upstairs is cover.

PLAY SITUATIONS

Three states. The drones react to context: routine, viewing or irregularity. A social success upstairs changes how this level greets the crew, but does not remove the drones.

The way to the case passes everything. Casket next to the door, cybertech on the left, antique with an aura in the middle. Describe it all before the case is even visible.

Factor missing. Venn scans, the display says “PHYSICAL FACTOR: PENDING”. 90 seconds. Where is the card right now, and who is standing next to Venn?

Back entrance through the nest. Whoever comes via the service ring enters the corridor through the drone node. Controlled if nobody touches anything; desperate if the guardians are already awake.

Foam. A consequence in the corridor: security foam from the ceiling. Vision and movement impaired, for everyone. Whoever controls the suppression plant decides when.

The watcher sees you. Astral activity → report (Alert +1), no attack. A mage can distract it, fool it or simply stay still.

The door slams shut. Dragon’s Deal: “You reach the case without resistance. In return the vault door closes behind you.” Now the ventilation duct, the cable pass-through and the packing table with tools matter.

GM ONLY

Running rolls

01

State position and effect, choose consequences, run clocks. Principle: consequences create new situations, not game over.

Position in the tower

POSITION	TYPICAL HERE
Controlled	registered viewing, cover holds, quiet workshop, alert 0–1
Risky	service wing without clearance, gondola in the wind, guards nearby
Desperate	in the open in the sensor corridor, guardian drones firing, Kade in melee, lockdown

Alert itself gives no dice penalty; the changed fiction shifts position and effect.

Consequences

FOUR TYPES

- **Reduced effect:** one effect level less.
- **Complication:** new danger, a door locks, the keycard is moved, Venn gets suspicious. On a clock: minor 1, normal 2, serious 3 segments.
- **Lost opportunity:** the window closes, another method is needed.
- **Harm:** see below.

A complication must not negate a success. Per consequence either resistance or armour. The GM decides whether resistance reduces or avoids, and so sets the tone.

Harm by position

RULE OF THUMB

POSITION	HARM
Controlled	level 1
Risky	level 2
Desperate	level 3 (lethal weapons: up to 4)

The rulebook only states desperate = severe harm; the rest is Blades practice. Temporary states (dazed, panicked) are complications, not harm.

Effect factors

- **Quality:** better gear than the opposition (fine items) = +1.
- **Scale:** group against individuals, drone swarm = ±1.
- **Potency:** weak spot, surprise, magic against the mundane, EMP against drones = +1.

A dominant factor overrides the rest (one against twenty). Zero effect is possible, then only a setup helps.

Clocks

SIZE	FOR
4–5	complex: the keycard lockbox, guards in the service wing
6–7	more complicated: guardian drones, the alert clock
8–10	daunting: break the mana barrier, the vault door without factors

Limited 1 · standard 2 · great 3 segments. Clocks track the obstacle, not the method (“guardian drones”, not “hack the drones”). Simple things need no clock: one roll decides.

Engagement roll

FORTUNE ROLL

1d6, ±1d each: bold / overly complex · the detail hits a weakness / the target is strong against it · contacts help / rivals interfere. Sprawl Whisperer: +1d.

- **6 + 6** first obstacle already overcome, dominant advantage
- **6** dominant advantage or initiative (controlled)
- **4/5** Risky
- **1-3** Desperate

Only holds for the first actions. Don’t describe the approach; cut straight to the first obstacle.

Fortune roll

For uncertainty without a runner action: does Kade notice the outage? Roll a fitting trait (tier, quality, magnitude) or 1–4d6 by situation, ±1d for major advantages and disadvantages. Critical exceptional · 6 good · 4/5 mixed · 1–3 bad.

Dragon’s deals

+1D FOR A CATCH

The GM or anyone at the table may offer one. It happens whatever the roll. Not on top of pushing.

- The invitation is real, but someone recognises your alias.
- Perfect scan, but Venn will remember your face.
- The drone goes offline; its last data burst is already out.
- The gondola gets you there, then locks itself outside.
- You reach the briefcase; the vault door closes behind you.

Flashback prices

0 edge ordinary, 1 complex or unlikely, 2+ elaborate with special opportunities. Then an action roll, a fortune roll or no roll, depending on the danger.

GM ONLY

Combat & opposition

02

Enemies don't roll. Their behaviour and attacks come out of the runners' action rolls. Security wants to isolate, hold and buy time; lethal force only on massive escalation.

Gala security

DISCREET · WELL EQUIPPED

- **Goal:** no visible incident in front of the VIPs.
- **Tactics:** address politely, separate, ask aside, escort. Tasers only behind closed doors.
- **Clock:** taking out a pair of guards 4.
- **Harm:** non-lethal, level 1–2.
- **Consequences:** radio call (alert +1), backup, identity recorded.

Dorian Kade HEAD OF SECURITY

- Cyberarms, wired reflexes, pistol. A master: the GM says what he has already done (gun drawn, exit blocked), and the runners must resist before they can act.
- Openly against him: **desperate**, effect usually limited (quality, reflexes).
- **Clock 6** to bring him down. Better: deceive, distract, avoid him.
- Won't shoot into a crowd. Keeps incidents small; prefers to pull people into a side room.
- Harm: level 2, with his gun drawn level 3.

Recon drones SMALL · FAST

- Small frame (–1 scale), flight, sensor array. Observe, capture faces, tag, follow.
- Easy to destroy: one standard hit does it.
- **The danger is the data burst:** alert +1, or a runner's identity is recorded.
- Intercept it before it reports and the rise is prevented.

Guardian drones

ARMOURED · ARMED

- Medium frame with plating and turret. **Clock 4** per drone (6 at alert 4+).
- Holdout, knives, fists: limited. Brutal weapon, Wreck, EMP: standard or potency.
- **Weak spots:** sensors, weapon module, maintenance port in the drone node.
- **Non-lethal first:** block, taser, containment foam.
- **Lethal** only if the runners are heavily armed or on massive escalation.

Drone escalation

Routine patrol by pattern

Viewing escort, count, compare identities

Irregularity step in between, demand re-auth, block paths, separate

Physical restrain, taser, foam

Weapons only against heavy weapons or massive escalation

External response FROM ALERT 6

Lots of time left: **response clock 4**. When full, a heavily armed team arrives; escape instead of fighting. Little time: the next big consequence is arriving backup.

Harm in the tower

LEVEL	EXAMPLES
1	cut by glass, twisted ankle, pepper: "sickened"
2	deep cut, concussion after a fall on the stairs
3	shot by a guardian drone, fall through the glass roof
4	only desperate with lethal means

Bangflash, taser jitters, stuck in foam: a temporary complication (dazed, held), not harm.

The bomb in the briefcase

- Only those who open it risk it. Keep it closed and nobody ever learns of it.
- Detect: Survey, Study, Engineer or Interface, depending on method.
- Disarm: risky in calm, desperate under drone fire.
- Detonation: contents destroyed, level 3 harm for the holder (not a death trap), alert rises sharply.

Violence & payoff

- Injured or dead guests or staff: at least as high alert (3 nuyen).
- Venn seriously hurt or killed: breach of contract.
- **Veyrath never fights.** If someone shoots at him, he withdraws.

GM ONLY

Magic in the tower

03

What is magical in the Meridian Spire and what the Awakened can see there. Magic is one more way, never a must: every obstacle can be solved mundanely too.

The vault shell

ORIGINAL CREATION

- Cultivated living tissue inside the walls: dark fibres like roots or muscle.
- Carries a **dual mana barrier**: physical and astral. Astral scouting or passage is severely hampered.
- Reacts to drilling and shocks; small wounds close.
- On alarm the fibres thicken.
- Damage is visible: fibres twitch, dark fluid seeps out.

Getting past the barrier

- **Break through:** clock 8, desperate, each roll alert +1. Loud and slow.
- **Study the door:** Assense or Study at the regular passage shows how the barrier opens in a controlled way. That is a setup: +1 effect or better position for your own way in.
- **Attack the wall:** the tissue reacts, heals, thickens. Damage to the shell counts for Veyrath like damage to the collection.

The astral watcher

OPTIONAL

- Patrols outside the barrier. Not a combat enemy.
- Notices unusual astral activity nearby: **alert +1**.
- That includes spells, sustained assensing, Hush's bright aura.
- Distract it (Assense, Influence) or stay quiet. Banishing focus: potency to drive it off.

What Assense reveals

EFFECT	INSIGHT
Limited	strong magic here; a wall is "alive"; something watches astrally.
Standard	dual barrier, the watcher and its round, the briefcase's aura among the pieces.
Great	how the barrier opens at the passage; which antiques are magical; the barrier is old and costly, no corp builds this for art.

Magic in the hoard

- **The briefcase:** faint, old, harmless aura. Stands out to the Awakened, triggers nothing.
- **Magical antiques:** distinguishable from merely expensive pieces. One is temptingly easy to take. No trap.

Spells in practice

- **Stunbolt** on a guard: Assense, risky, silent, non-lethal. A guard is weak: cost 1 edge or drain 1. Near level 110 the watcher notices.
- **Veil:** people see the illusion, **cameras see the truth**. Needs concentration; when challenged, re-roll Assense or the veil drops.
- The spell's signature clings to caster's spot and target for minutes and can be tracked.

Magical consequences

- **Drain** comes from the spell cost (spell potential = Assense rating, Ravn 1): below it 1 edge or drain 1, equal 1 edge + drain 1, above 1 edge + drain 2.
- From the roll: backlash harm ("lightly toasted", level 1), spell out of control.
- Astral attention: the watcher reports, alert +1.
- Resistance: Ravn (hermetic) Intuition, Hush Body.

Clues to Veyrath

- **Ravn** recognises the grown dual barrier as decades of work: someone very old lives here.
- Vesna (Ravn's spirit) said the tower "has a heartbeat".
- **Hush's** strange trinket may show a vast shadow over the façade at the vault door.
- Don't hold back a truth the runners have earned.

Veyrath

REVEAL

- Appears only during or after the escape and speaks straight into the runners' minds with dragonspeech.
- **Seeing a dragon:** onlookers freeze up or flee unless they resist with Willpower. If he keeps his distance, a brief shock is enough.
- Dragons are dual-natured: their astral presence is visible from afar unless hidden. Veyrath hides his inside the tower.
- Judges, doesn't threaten, doesn't block. **Never a combat encounter.**

GM ONLY

Alert, Matrix & payoff

04

The alert clock shows what building security knows and does right now. It rises when an action plausibly draws attention, and drops when the fiction allows it.

Alert stages

6 SEGMENTS

- **0–1 Routine** event deviation. Standard patrols. Nobody searches.
- **2–3 Suspicion** cameras cross-check, doors demand re-auth, drones watch, staff are questioned.
- **4–5 Alarm** drones search, service routes closed, lifts stop or reroute, identified runners are tracked.
- **6 Lockdown** alarm confirmed, exits sealed, external response called.

How much alert?

TRIGGER	ALERT
minor complication: wrong area, watcher notices magic	+1
complication: identity checked and failed, drone report	+2
serious complication: door forced, gunfire, explosion	+3
action works directly on the clock	by effect

Not every failure raises alert. Harm, lost gear or a blocked door often fit better.

Lowering alert

Only through a concrete deed: a convincing explanation, old camera footage, a sensor passed off as a fault, a drone intercepted, a door log posing as maintenance, a party incident as an excuse. Success: alert drops by effect or a looming rise is cancelled.

Networked systems

SYSTEM	LEVER
Guest list, rosters	slip in names, forge a shift
Cameras	loop, old footage, angles
Lifts	stop, reroute, fake the floor
Door logs	pass access off as maintenance
Façade gondola	drive command, docking point 110
Drones	fool target recognition, orders, maintenance port
Skycab transponder 1/2/3	landing clearance on the roof

Offline

- **The briefcase** transmits nothing and can't be located via the Matrix. Offline means: only hackable by cable, directly at the device.
- **Keycard lockbox** in the event office: removal is logged, but the lock is physical.
- The **vault door** logs every attempt; a clean two-factor entry raises no alarm.

Matrix consequences

- ICe alerted or corners the hacker; next hack desperate.
- "Traced" clock: when full, the location is known. Going offline clears it but drops all control taken.
- Device damaged, shut down or jacked; target icon hidden.
- Usable trace: alert +1.
- Breach opens at once but alerts the system.

Repeated attempts only get harder when the fiction gives a reason.

Payoff

ALERT AT THE END	NUYEN
Low 0–1	6
Medium 2–5	5
High / lockdown 6	3

- Injured or dead guests or staff: at least as high alert.
- Venn seriously hurt or killed: clear breach of contract.
- Damage to the collection or extra loot can cut further.

Veyrath's verdict

RESULT	IF …
Ideal	briefcase closed, no loot, collection intact, Venn unharmed, little violence, teamwork
Usable	job done, but medium/high alert or avoidable escalation
Unfit	briefcase opened (even expertly), contents destroyed, Venn hurt, loot, indiscriminate killing

Feuerprobe Runner

Eight pregenerated runners for the one-shot in the Meridian Spire · Seattle 2080

Welcome to the shadows

Seattle, 2080. The city belongs to the megacorporations. Their towers stand on extraterritorial ground, their security services replace the police, their advertising hangs as an AR layer over every street. In Bellevue the money glitters; in the Redmond Barrens the power goes out for hours.

Metahumans. Since the Awakening of magic (2011) and goblinization (2021) there are elves, dwarves, orks and trolls. They are neighbors, colleagues, children. Prejudice against orks and trolls is still everyday life, and some elves act as if they were something better.

The Matrix. Everyone carries a commlink, every surface talks to you. Those who want to go deeper enter virtual reality via trodes or datajack. Hackers crack corporate systems; corporate spiders hunt them.

Magic. The Awakened are rare and in demand. Mages cast spells and summon spirits; adepts channel magic into their bodies. There is astral space, mana barriers and dragons who run corporations and appear on the news.

Runners. You are professionals without an official existence. Whoever has no SIN (System Identification Number) does not exist for the state: no account, no apartment, no rights. In return there are jobs from people who call themselves *Mr. Johnson*, paid in nuyen. The old rule: Never trust anyone. Never shoot first. Stick to the deal.

How to read your sheet

ACTIONS Twelve skills in three groups. Roll as many d6 as the action has dots and count only the highest: **6** full success, **4/5** success with a consequence, **1–3** bad. Two sixes are a critical. Zero dots: roll two dice, the worse one counts.

POSITION Before the roll the GM says how dangerous (controlled, risky, desperate) and how effective (limited, standard, great) your approach is. You may trade: more risk for more effect.

EDGE Your reserve (9 boxes). 2 edge: push yourself, +1d or more effect. 1 edge: assist a teammate. You may soften a consequence with a resistance roll; the roll decides what it costs. A full edge track means a trauma.

RESISTANCE Roll with the attribute group: as many d6 as you have actions with at least one dot there. The value is on the sheet.

HARM Level 1 (lesser): less effect. Level 2 (moderate): −1d. Level 3 (severe): you need help. Level 4 is fatal. Armor boxes absorb harm; special armor only what your ability names.

LOAD Before the run you only decide how much you carry (light 3, normal 5, heavy 6). Which items those are you decide when you need them. ● marks our recommendation for this run.

FLASHBACK You do not have to plan everything ahead. Mid-run, explain what you had prepared and pay edge for it (0 to 2, depending on effort).

KARMA At the end of the session: karma for your playbook triggers, for expressing heritage or beliefs, and when your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

NAME, GENDER, FACE

The sheets fix neither name nor gender. The big title is only the street name the character is known by in the shadows; you enter name and pronouns at the top of the sheet yourself. Look, heritage and background are suggestions you can adjust with the GM.

HOW THE NUMBERS WORK

Every sheet has 7 action dots (three from the playbook, four free), no action above 2. Awakened characters carry their required ability in addition to the chosen starting ability. The three playbook dots are on your official playbook sheet; if they differ from here, simply move one of the free dots.

Recommended crews for 3–4 players. Each line-up covers entry, keycard, Venn and the way down to 110 in its own way.

- **The Invitation:** Mercer (Face), Kessel (Hacker), Bastion (Muscle), Ravn (Mage). In through the glass elevator, Venn in conversation, cameras under control, a shield in front of the crew and a look into astral space.
- **The Quiet Ones:** Chameleon (Snake), Fizz (Punk), Hush (Adept), Kessel (Hacker). Through the garage as staff, keycard from the event office, maintenance shaft down to 110, not a shot fired.
- **The Air Route:** Zephyr (Rigger), Fizz (Punk), Bastion (Muscle), Hush (Adept). Onto the roof from above, ladder and shaft, gondola to the technical airlock, skycab for the getaway.
- **Three players:** Mercer, Fizz and Ravn: charm, climbing and magic. Replace Kessel’s camera work with flashbacks and Fizz’s EMP grenades.

Mercer

FACE · ELF · SIN REVOKED · FAKE

Face: smooth, connected, invited everywhere

NAME your choice · “Mercer” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · …

Role in the run: Opens doors others would have to force: invitation, guest list, a conversation with Dr. Venn. The reason the crew gets into the glass elevator at all.

PROFILE

LOOK	Late thirties, hair dyed silver-grey, tailored evening wear in charcoal, a single earring of real gold. You smile before you speak.
HERITAGE	North America · born in Tír Tairngire (Portland), in Seattle since 2071
BACKGROUND	Corporate · art PR for a corporate gallery in Bellevue, fired after a scandal
VICE	Luxury · Chef Horowitz’s private dinners at the Wilder Hotel, Downtown
IDN (SIN)	Your own SIN still exists but is revoked. A fake SIN under an alias of your choice, occupation art consultant, good quality.
CONTACTS	Shrewd Friends

METATYPE: ELF

Low-light Vision. You can see in low light as well as if it were well lit.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION	Intuition · Resistance 1d
Engineer tech, tinkering, repairs	●○○○
Interface Matrix, hacking, controlling devices	○○○○
Stalk tracking, hunting, aiming	○○○○
Survey observing, reading the scene	●○○○

BODY	Body · Resistance 1d
Fight combat, melee, gunfire	○○○○
Finesse dexterity, precision, vehicles	●○○○
Prowl sneaking, climbing, hiding	○○○○
Wreck	○○○○

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Sprawl Whisperer START

You gain +1d to Consort when you gather information on a target for a run. You get +1d to the engagement roll for that operation.

GEAR · LOAD

0 ●	**Fine Outfit** A suit of clothes that marks you as an executive, an officer of rank or the undisputed leader of a gang, badges and accoutrements included.
0 ●	**Fine Nightlife Subscription** Prepaid credit at the city’s popular clubs and restaurants. Intoxicates and impresses.
1 ●	**Privacy Generator** A small tabletop device for a short conversation free of audio surveillance. Perfect for five minutes with Dr. Venn in the conservatory.
1	**Street Drugs** Up to three doses: Bluecoke, Glow, Nu-Ganja, Red Rock. Refills itself during downtime.

Pointed Ears. You hear from further away. Spend 1 edge to perceive beyond normal limits for several minutes (whispers in a noisy room, ultrasound).

Quick. You remain fast at normal load.

Graceful. When you resist a consequence of social pressure, it costs only 1 edge, regardless of the roll.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants. You consider chrome a flaw and let people notice. Instead you carry a high-end commlink and contact lenses with an AR overlay.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with charisma or conspiracy.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER — Willpower · Resistance 3d

Command orders, intimidation	●○○○
Consort rapport, networking, contacts	●●○○
Influence persuasion, deceit, charm	●●○○
Study analysis, knowledge, spellcasting	●○○○

EDGE — 9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM — level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	...	...
LEVEL 2 −1d	...	...
LEVEL 3 needs help	...	

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD — Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

2	**Extra Fine Outfit** Like the Fine Outfit, one step more expensive: gala level.
0	**An Entourage** Three to five bodyguards, fans and retainers loyal only to you. Quality equals Tier when they can help.

● recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson's pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Ines Okonkwo-Harada, gallerist. Curates in Bellevue and still owes Mercer. She can put a name on the guest list of the Vesperline gala or tell you which collectors are there tonight.

RIVAL

Tobias Wren, society reporter. Writes for a trid gossip channel, knows every face on the scene and once covered Mercer's fall with relish. He is invited tonight.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You used to be inside: the invitations, the receptions, the right people. A scandal you did not cause threw you out. Six nuyen is good money, but the real payoff is one evening standing at the top again. And maybe the name behind it all.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Foyer & security arch:** With the Fine Outfit and a name from Ines you get waved through. Sprawl Whisperer gives the crew +1d on the engagement roll if you did your research.
- **Gallery & conservatory:** Dr. Venn only talks to people who take art seriously. Consort 2 and Study 1 are enough to ask for a private viewing. The Privacy Generator buys five undisturbed minutes.
- **Lowering Alert:** When a guard spots a deviation, you deliver the plausible explanation before they reach for the radio.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: SINS, ELVES AND THE PRICE OF EXISTING

A SIN (System Identification Number) is more than an ID in the Sixth World: bank account, apartment, health insurance, the right to vote. Lose it and you officially stop existing. Mercer comes from Tír Tairngire, the elven nation south of Seattle, where bloodline decides careers. That Mercer now works with ork punks counts as a disgrace in the family.

GM ONLY

Mercer's real face has been on a Bellevue blacklist since the gallery scandal, and Kade's arch checks it. If Mercer enters the foyer undisguised, that counts as a deviation (silent check, Alert +1). Tobias Wren is the perfect Dragon's Deal: "The invitation is real, but someone at the party recognizes your alias." Mercer also has a fine nose for money and is the first to sense that someone very old and very rich stands behind Vesperline.

Chameleon

SNAKE | MENSCH | FAKE SIN

Snake: lies, manipulation, a thousand faces

NAME your choice · “Chameleon” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · …

Role in the run: Becomes someone who is allowed to be here: catering, insurance assessor, security. Fetches the keycard without anyone noticing it was fetched.

PROFILE

LOOK	Early thirties, completely unremarkable on request. Today: dark suit, glasses without prescription, hair pulled back. Tomorrow: someone else entirely.
HERITAGE	North America · Los Angeles (California Free State), in Seattle for five years
BACKGROUND	Media · stunt double and bit parts in trid series, then acting lessons for people who did not want to act
VICE	Gambling · Krist’s fight clubs under the Kingdome grounds, bets on anything that moves
IDN (SIN)	None of your own anymore. The fake SIN changes with the role; the current one reads “Dr. L. Voss, art insurance” (see Fine Cover Identity). You choose the first name to fit the part.
CONTACTS	Sly Friends

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION — Intuition · Resistance 1d

- **Engineer** — tech, tinkering, repairs
- **Interface** — Matrix, hacking, controlling devices
- **Stalk** — tracking, hunting, aiming
- **Survey** — observing, reading the scene

BODY — Body · Resistance 2d

- **Fight** — combat, melee, gunfire
- **Finesse** — dexterity, precision, vehicles
- **Prowl** — sneaking, climbing, hiding
- **Wreck**

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Master of Disguise START

When you use a disguise or other form of covert misdirection, you get +1d to rolls to confuse or deflect suspicion. When you throw off your disguise, the resulting surprise gives you the initiative in the situation.

GEAR · LOAD

1 • **Fine Disguise Kit** A vial of pheromones and a thermoplastic mask kit with expert appliances. May increase the effect of your deceptions.

0 • **Fine Cover Identity** Fake licenses, business holo-cards, planted rumors and relationships: enough to pass as a different person.

0 • **Concealed Holdout Pistol** Low calibre, vanished up a sleeve. Hard to find even in a search.

0 **Blackmail Supplies** Compromising recordings, embarrassing video or

METATYPE: MENSCH

Mensch. No special traits. By the rules you may instead pick up to two free permutations to represent an easier life. Talk it over with the GM or skip it.

IMPLANTS & BODY

An inconspicuous voice modulator in the larynx (changes pitch and accent) and a datajack behind the ear for simsense recordings from your trid days.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with deception or information.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER — Willpower · Resistance 3d

Command orders, intimidation	○○○○
Consort rapport, networking, contacts	●○○○
Influence persuasion, deceit, charm	●●○○
Study analysis, knowledge, spellcasting	●○○○

EDGE — 9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM — level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	...	...
LEVEL 2 −1d	...	...
LEVEL 3 needs help	...	

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD — Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

incriminating evidence.

0 **Red Rock** One dose: the victim slips into a calm, suggestible state, similar to hypnosis.

1 ● **Subterfuge Supplies** Standard gear: makeup kit, subvocal communicator, janitor outfit, blank licenses, reversible coat.

● recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson’s pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Nadia Feld, shift planner at Silberkante Catering. Sells empty shift slots at galas for cash. She knows Silberkante is catering the Meridian Spire tonight and what the shift list on the supervisor’s tablet looks like.

RIVAL

Detective Marisol Ruiz, contracted police service. Missed Chameleon by a hair two years ago and has collected every recording of a person who never shows up twice since.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

The bookies want their money and you have skipped town too often already. But honestly: a gala, a vault, a curator with a cybereye and a case nobody may open. It is the best role you have been offered in years.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Garage & freight lobby:** With Nadia’s shift slot and a catering uniform you come in over the loading dock. The shift supervisor scans her tablet: Master of Disguise gives you +1d when she hesitates.
- **Event office & hatch:** In a security uniform you demand the keycard “on Kade’s orders for the return transport”. Influence 2, risky. On a 4/5 the event manager calls Kade.
- **Guest restroom & locker room:** In as a guest, out as staff. Fine Cover Identity carries you as an insurance assessor all the way to Dr. Venn.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: TRIDEO, SIMSENSE AND IDENTITIES FOR SALE

Trid is the television of the Sixth World: three-dimensional, everywhere, with stars more powerful than senators. Simsense goes further and plays feelings and senses straight into the brain. Anyone who was famous in this world knows how cheap identity is: on the black market a SIN costs less than a good dinner, but it only holds as long as nobody looks closely.

GM ONLY

The cover identity “Dr. Voss” really exists: a Zurich art insurer Dr. Venn has exchanged e-mails with. Venn will politely ask how the weather was in Zurich. A slip here makes Venn suspicious (consequence); a success opens the private viewing. Detective Ruiz is not in the Spire, but her name suits the Heat reckoning after the run.

Kessel

HACKER | ZWERG | SINLESS · OWN FAKE

Hacker: digital spy and virtual weapon

NAME your choice · “Kessel” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · ...

Role in the run: Guest list, cameras, elevators, drones: anything with a network is your door. You see the building as a data flow and find the spot where it stalls.

PROFILE

LOOK	Mid twenties, broad shoulders, braided hair with a data cable as jewelry. Hoodie covered in stickers, the cyberdeck belt underneath.
HERITAGE	North America · Puyallup, Seattle, grew up in the shadow of the Ash Pit
BACKGROUND	Academic · Matrix informatics at U-Dub, expelled in the third semester for rewriting the grading system
VICE	Obligation · two younger siblings in Puyallup whose school fees and clinic bills you pay
IDN (SIN)	Never had a real one. You built the fake SIN yourself; it survives every routine check and no targeted one.
CONTACTS	1337 Friends

METATYPE: ZWERG

Thermal Senses. Your senses detect nearby thermal signatures that are normally invisible.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION — Intuition · Resistance 3d

Engineer tech, tinkering, repairs	●○○○
Interface Matrix, hacking, controlling devices	●●○○
Stalk tracking, hunting, aiming	○○○○
Survey observing, reading the scene	●○○○

BODY — Body · Resistance 1d

Fight combat, melee, gunfire	○○○○
Finesse dexterity, precision, vehicles	○○○○
Prowl sneaking, climbing, hiding	●○○○
Wreck	○○○○

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Search Protocol START

You are always aware of online devices in your presence. Take +1d when you gather information about high technology by any means.

GEAR · LOAD

1 •	**A Scratch-Built Cyberdeck** A modified comm that spots hidden data trails and quietly exploits them. Feature: smart (cannot be hacked to turn against you).
0 •	**Suite of Warez** Illegal apps for the cyberdeck: Armor, Arsenal, Breach, Mask. Executing several warez in one run draws attention.
0 •	**Blueprints** A database of architectural and city plans. Say which plans you loaded when the run starts.
1	**Fine Surveillance Gear** Signal scanner, wireless data taps, tracer tags, long-range audio and video sensors.

Fun-sized. You are not fast at light load, but you remain inconspicuous at normal load. People underestimate you, and your stature.

Tenacious. You do not suffer a harm penalty until an entire row is filled.

Thiccblood. Alcohol does not linger. Resisting poison or disease costs only 1 edge.

IMPLANTS & BODY

Datajack at the left temple, cybereyes with image link and low-light amplifier. Your cyberdeck “Kessel” is soldered together from three corporate commlinks and carries a pendant from your sister.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with information or cybercrime.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER — Willpower · Resistance 2d

Command orders, intimidation	○ ○ ○ ○
Consort rapport, networking, contacts	● ○ ○ ○
Influence persuasion, deceit, charm	○ ○ ○ ○
Study analysis, knowledge, spellcasting	● ○ ○ ○

EDGE — 9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM — level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	…	…
LEVEL 2 −1d	…	…
LEVEL 3 needs help	…	

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD — Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

0	**VR Trodes** A lightweight headband for entering virtual reality without a datajack.
1	**Portable VR Kit** A thin case with a seat and trodes: the safe corner from which you take over the building.

• recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson's pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Glitch, former building-automation spider. Maintained the elevator controls of the Meridian Spire as a subcontractor. Knows the building-control node in the garage, the maintenance schedule of the facade gondola and the rule that the freight elevator does not stop at 110.

RIVAL

Nullpunkt, Matrix competition. Sells the same exploits to the same people, just an hour earlier. Claims Kessel's cyberdeck is "a toaster with ambitions".

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

The clinic in Puyallup keeps sending reminders. Six nuyen clears the rest. And Glitch said something that will not let you go: "Level 110 has its own host. Nobody builds that for art."

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Garage, building-control node:** From here you reach elevators, doors and the garage cameras. Not level 110, but you can make the freight elevator stop there.
- **Security room & cameras:** Swap footage, mark a sensor as defective: that is how Alert drops again. Search Protocol tells you which drone is transmitting right now.
- **Security server 110:** Physical access to doors, sensors and drone logic of the level. Controlled, but every login is logged: Heat after the run.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: THE MATRIX

The Matrix is everywhere: as augmented reality over the street, as virtual reality when you plug in via trodes or datajack. Corporations run hosts; their security hackers are called spiders. Break in and you risk biofeedback that injures the body. Deckers like Kessel build their tools from scrap because a legal cyberdeck costs more than an apartment in Bellevue.

GM ONLY

Kessel's siblings are the lever for Veyrath's greed test: the compact piece of cybertechnology in the collection is exactly the prosthetic controller the sister needs. Describe it when Kessel sees the case. Glitch is right: the host of 110 is separate from the building host (plan 110, location 8). A hack from the garage cannot reach it; physical access in the server room can.

Zephyr

RIGGER · MENSCH · SIN “KILLED IN ACTION”

Rigger: technology, flying skill, control over every machine

NAME your choice · “Zephyr” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · …

Role in the run: Air route, facade gondola, skycab, drones in the shaft: where others look for a door, you see a flight corridor. You get the crew up and back down.

PROFILE

LOOK	Late thirties, sun-weathered, short hair, a flight jacket with the patches cut off. Control-rig jacks at the neck, always a tool belt at the hip.
HERITAGE	North America · Atlanta (CAS), drone missions for the UCAS Army, stuck in Seattle since
BACKGROUND	Military · reconnaissance and transport drones in the Desert Wars, dishonorably discharged after refusing an order
VICE	Stupor · cheap synth whisky at the hangar bar “Cap’s” at Everett field, at night when the memories get loud
IDN (SIN)	Your real military SIN was set to “killed in action” when you left. For everyday life you carry a fake civilian SIN.
CONTACTS	Handy Friends

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION	Intuition · Resistance 4d
Engineer tech, tinkering, repairs	●●○○
Interface Matrix, hacking, controlling devices	●○○○
Stalk tracking, hunting, aiming	●○○○
Survey observing, reading the scene	●○○○

BODY	Body · Resistance 1d
Fight combat, melee, gunfire	○○○○
Finesse dexterity, precision, vehicles	●●○○
Prowl sneaking, climbing, hiding	○○○○
Wreck	○○○○

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Ace START

You can Finesse a vehicle to take off, control or land it, regardless of its means of propulsion. You gain potency when you make difficult maneuvers while piloting a vehicle.

GEAR · LOAD

- 0 • **A Configured Drone** “Dragonfly”: a palm-sized rotor drone with camera and microphone, fits through the drone shaft. More features cost one special item choice each.
- 0 • **A Personal Vehicle** A heavy motorcycle with sidecar, waiting at the VIP drop-off or the ramp. Seats two, drives autonomously.
- 1 • **Utility Harness** Three chemicals or gadgets: Hypersolvent, Hyperglue, Thermite Gel, Nightshades, Sensor Tag, Spatial Scanner, Thermite Rod, Vehicular Override.

METATYPE: MENSCH

Mensch. No special traits. By the rules you may instead pick up to two free permutations. Talk it over with the GM or skip it.

IMPLANTS & BODY

A control rig in the neck that links you directly to drones and vehicles. When you “rig”, your body slumps and breathes shallowly. Your left hand is a plain army-issue prosthesis.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with technical skill or control.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER

Willpower · Resistance 0d

Command
orders, intimidation

Consort
rapport, networking, contacts

Influence
persuasion, deceit, charm

Study
analysis, knowledge, spellcasting

EDGE

9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM

level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	…	…
LEVEL 2 −1d	…	…
LEVEL 3 needs help	…	

ARMOR

Armor · Heavy · Special

LOAD

Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

Light 3 · **Normal 5** · Heavy 6

1	**Medical Supplies** Three sprays or patches: Antidote Patch, Hard-Clot, Sterilizer, Stim Patch, Stun Patch.
1	**Fine Electrical Tools** Soldering irons, special wrenches, precision sensors, a headlamp with magnification.

• recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson's pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

"Cap" Okafor, tilt-rotor pilot. Flies freight routes over the Sound and is not afraid of a pass at 400 meters. She drops the crew above the roof or picks them up again at the east facade.

RIVAL

Dispatcher Vance, Seattle skycab control. Once caught Zephyr rerouting a skycab without clearance. He knows the control rig's signature and reports it with pleasure.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You want your old reconnaissance drone back; a scrap dealer in Tacoma holds it for twelve nuyen. Six is a start. And this run has altitude, wind and a tower that deserves a proper approach.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Roof & skycab pad:** With Ace and Cap you come in from above. The approach transponder grants hacked skycabs landing clearance; without clearance the cab circles and calls in.
- **Facade gondola:** Control box on the roof, docking point on 110. Finesse 2 for the ride in the wind, Vehicular Override from the Utility Harness for the electronics.
- **Drone shaft:** "Dragonfly" flies from the garage to the kitchen on 111 and up to the roof. Gear in portions, eyes everywhere, and nobody asks a delivery drone for an invitation.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: RIGGERS, DRONES AND CORPORATE WARS

A control rig links the nervous system directly to machines: whoever rigs feels the rotor like their own hand. Such implants cost Essence, a piece of humanity that cannot be bought back. The Desert Wars are the televised wars of the corporations, mercenaries fighting in front of cameras. Anyone who flew there knows the difference between a target and a person.

GM ONLY

Zephyr's control rig is registered army property. Kade's security arch recognizes military augmentation and reports it silently (Alert +1) if Zephyr walks through the foyer. The gondola ride is the classic Dragon's Deal: "It takes you exactly to the target and then locks itself to the outside of the building." Cap flies reliably, but only once: a second pass draws the attention of airspace control.

Bastion

MUSCLE · TROLL · CORPORATE SIN EXPIRED

Muscle: dangerous, intimidating, the crew's shield

NAME your choice · "Bastion" is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · ...

Role in the run: Stands between the crew and whatever goes wrong. Knows how security people think because you were one. Masters violence instead of needing it.

PROFILE

LOOK	2.40 m, calm movements, one horn sawn off (the other polished). Dark coat over a bulletproof vest, a voice like a refrigerator starting up.
HERITAGE	Europe · Hamburg (Allied German States), brought to Seattle ten years ago on a security contract
BACKGROUND	Law · twelve years of corporate security and close protection at Sentinel Solutions, fired for refusing a shoot order
VICE	Obligation · your ex and your daughter in Tacoma, whose school fees you transfer on time, whatever it costs
IDN (SIN)	A real corporate SIN from Sentinel Solutions, expired with the dismissal. Never replaced, so every checkpoint is a problem.
CONTACTS	Dangerous Friends

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION	Intuition · Resistance 1d
Engineer tech, tinkering, repairs	○○○○
Interface Matrix, hacking, controlling devices	○○○○
Stalk tracking, hunting, aiming	○○○○
Survey observing, reading the scene	●○○○

BODY	Body · Resistance 2d
Fight combat, melee, gunfire	●●○○
Finesse dexterity, precision, vehicles	○○○○
Prowl sneaking, climbing, hiding	○○○○
Wreck	●○○○

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Bodyguard START

When you protect a teammate, take +1d to your resistance roll. When you gather information to anticipate possible threats in the current situation, you get +1 effect.

GEAR · LOAD

1 •	**Light Armor** Lighter and less conspicuous than normal armor, with a (real or forged) security license. Passes the arch in the foyer plausibly.
1 •	**Fine Scary Weapon/Tool** Shock gloves: more effect when you intimidate, not more harm. Non-lethal when it has to be.
0 •	**Containment Manacles** Self-latching manacles with impact-resistant chain. A souvenir from the security days.
2	**Fine Brutal Weapon** A devastating heavy weapon, here a shotgun from Sentinel stock. Potency when power or reach matter.

METATYPE: TROLL

Thermal Senses. Your senses detect nearby thermal signatures.

Oversized. You are never inconspicuous (not even at light load), but you are not slower at heavy load and carry +1 load. People fear your kind.

Troll Armor. Skin and bones are hardened: one extra armor box and +1d on resistance rolls with Body.

Horned. Horns as weapons. You had one removed; the other makes people nervous.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants, on principle. “I have seen enough chrome in faces that felt nothing anymore.” Kevlar under the coat instead, and a security license that still looks real.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with violence or coercion.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER

Willpower · Resistance 3d

- **Command** — orders, intimidation ●○○○
- **Consort** — rapport, networking, contacts ●○○○
- **Influence** — persuasion, deceit, charm ○○○○
- **Study** — analysis, knowledge, spellcasting ●○○○

EDGE

9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM

level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	…	…
LEVEL 2 −1d	…	…
LEVEL 3 needs help	…	

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD

Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

0		**Kamikaze Vial** Combat drug: strength, pain tolerance, rage for minutes. Then two consequences: “Can’t tell friend from foe” and “Can’t stop until they’re all broken”.
1	●	**A Medieval Weapon** Standard: a telescopic baton. Getting medieval, but under control.

● recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson's pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Doc Amsel, street doctor in Tacoma. Patches up runners without questions and amputated Bastion's horn. She knows every bodyguard in town who is on duty at a gala tonight.

RIVAL

Dorian Kade, head of security at the gala. Was Bastion's team leader at Sentinel Solutions and signed the dismissal. Kade has a memory for faces and two chromed arms Bastion never liked.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You need the money for Tacoma, but you take the job because Mr. Johnson said: no wetwork. A run where nobody dies, in a tower Kade guards. You want to prove that security can be beaten without a shoot order.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Foyer & security arch:** Light Armor with a license plus Oversized means: they see you, but they expect you too. As a hired bodyguard of a guest you are plausible.
- **Drone node 110:** Guardian drones block first and shoot last. Bodyguard gives you +1d when you put yourself in front of the crew and +1 effect when you read their states.
- **Kade:** You know his routine, his twitches, his pride. Consort or Command to read him, Survey to predict his rounds. As long as he does not see you.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: TROLLS, GOBLINIZATION AND CORPORATE SECURITY

In 2021 people all over the world turned into orks and trolls overnight: goblinization. Trolls are strong, armored and live with doors, chairs and prejudices not built for them. Corporations like hiring them as security and dislike giving them responsibility. A troll who refuses a shoot order is a legend in the shadows and an HR case in Bellevue.

GM ONLY

Kade recognizes Bastion at once if he sees the character undisguised: no siren, but a conversation ("Well now. I thought you were doing night watch in Tacoma these days."). Afterwards he does not let Bastion out of his sight (Alert +1, one guard stays in view), but he might also ask something useful to the crew. Bastion's test is not greed but honor: Veyrath judges especially whether violence is avoided when violence would be easier.

Fizz

PUNK | ORK | SINLESS

Punk: wily, streetwise, chaos with a plan

NAME your choice · “Fizz” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · …

Role in the run: Takes the routes that officially do not exist: access ladder, maintenance shaft, glass roof, ceiling void. Creates distractions when things get hot, and is the first one back outside.

PROFILE

LOOK	19, wiry, neon-green streaks, tusk caps made from spray-can aluminium. Hoodie, climbing gloves, hoverboard under one arm. You chew gum constantly.
HERITAGE	North America · Redmond Barrens, Seattle. Never been further than Bellevue, and only to steal.
BACKGROUND	Underworld · courier runs and climbing for the Rusted Halos, a go-gang you left when the leader started killing
VICE	Pleasure · rooftop parties above Glow City, adrenaline, loud music, anything that tastes like life
IDN (SIN)	None. Never had one. To you the city is a climbing wall without ID checks.
CONTACTS	Shady Friends

METATYPE: ORK

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION — Intuition · Resistance 1d

Engineer	tech, tinkering, repairs	○○○○
Interface	Matrix, hacking, controlling devices	○○○○
Stalk	tracking, hunting, aiming	○○○○
Survey	observing, reading the scene	●○○○

BODY — Body · Resistance 4d

Fight	combat, melee, gunfire	●○○○
Finesse	dexterity, precision, vehicles	●○○○
Prowl	sneaking, climbing, hiding	●●○○
Wreck		●○○○

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Catch Me If You Can START

You may expend your special armor to resist a consequence from detection or security measures, or to push yourself for a feat of escape or stealth.

GEAR · LOAD

1 •	**Gecko Gloves** Nanofiber gloves with extreme adhesion: climb smooth and vertical surfaces, hold things securely.
1 •	**Fine Stealth Outfit** A full bodysuit of smart cloth that blends you into the darkness.
1 •	**Explosives** Three electronic bombs on a strap: Bangflash, EMP Grenade, Pepper Smoke, Tear Gas. EMP against drones, smoke against cameras.
0 •	**Stunlock Vial** Tranquilizer for an hour of sleep. Sprayed in the face it works briefly but hard.

Low-light Vision. You can see in low light as well as if it were well lit.

Foolish Pride. Regain 1 edge when you roll a critical on a desperate action roll.

Numbskull. Spend 1 edge to ignore a harm penalty (including incapacitation) for an action.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants, but you would love cybereyes. Instead a scratched commlink with a climbing app, gecko gloves and a hoverboard with hand-sprayed flames.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with surprise or mayhem.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER	Willpower · Resistance 1d
Command orders, intimidation	○○○○
Consort rapport, networking, contacts	○○○○
Influence persuasion, deceit, charm	●○○○
Study analysis, knowledge, spellcasting	○○○○

EDGE 9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	...	...
LEVEL 2 −1d	...	...
LEVEL 3 needs help	...	

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

1 **Fine Punk Stuff** A small hoverboard for tricks, with graphics of your choice. Or spiked boots, or a fanny pack full of marbles.

2 **Climbing Gear** Standard: grappling hooks, suction gloves, carabiners. For anyone without gecko gloves.

● recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson’s pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Mondo, facade cleaner for the maintenance firm. Rides the Meridian Spire’s gondola every Tuesday. He tells you where the control box sits, when the schedule calls for a run and that the terrace camera only sees the drone pad.

RIVAL

Ripfang, leader of the Rusted Halos. Takes it personally that Fizz left. His gang controls the streets around the approach to Bellevue.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

Your little brother Teo is eleven and starting to think the Rusted Halos are cool. Six nuyen is an apartment outside the Barrens. Besides: 112 floors of glass. You have never seen anything that tall that you have not climbed.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Access ladder & maintenance shaft:** From the terrace on 111 to the roof, from the roof down the shaft to 110, without touching the party. Catch Me If You Can pays for the moment a sensor trips after all.
- **Ceiling void:** From the locker room over the partition wall into the event office. Tight, dark, exactly your thing. The keycard lies below in its box.
- **Distraction:** Pepper smoke in the salon, a guest falls into the pool, a tray tips over: you buy the crew the two minutes in which nobody is watching.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: THE BARRENS, GO-GANGS AND LIFE WITHOUT A SIN

Redmond used to be a tech suburb. Today the Barrens are a district without power, police or garbage collection, where gangs are the order. Those born here often have no SIN: no school, no doctor, no way out except the shadows. Orks are born where humans move away. Fizz does not consider that fate, but a wall you can climb.

GM ONLY

Foolish Pride is also a character trait: Fizz cannot resist a dare. The jewel casket lies in the collection right next to the door and fits in the fanny pack. Describe it before you describe the case. Mondo’s knowledge of the gondola is real, but every ride is logged (roof plan, location 7). Ripfang can show up as a response-clock complication during the escape through the Barrens.

Hush

ADEPT | MENSCH | REAL SIN

Adept: magic in the body, perfection as a path

NAME your choice · “Hush” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · …

Role in the run: Moves where sensors stand and senses danger before it arrives. Reads people like a pulse. Solves conflicts with a grip instead of a bullet.

PROFILE

LOOK	Early thirties, slim, very upright, short black hair. Plain dark clothes without logos; fine white tattoos on neck and the backs of the hands that glow in astral space.
HERITAGE	Asia · Seoul, moved to Seattle with your parents as a child; grew up between two languages and a dojo
BACKGROUND	Academic · dropped philosophy, taught martial arts for ten years, then security consulting until too many contracts raised questions
VICE	Faith · meditation at Master Oyelaran’s dojo in Georgetown. You call it discipline; it is an addiction to stillness.
IDN (SIN)	A real, unremarkable SIN. You are registered, pay taxes and exist for the state as someone who teaches martial arts.
CONTACTS	Strange Friends

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION — Intuition · Resistance 2d

- **Engineer** — tech, tinkering, repairs ○○○○
- **Interface** — Matrix, hacking, controlling devices ○○○○
- **Stalk** — tracking, hunting, aiming ●○○○
- **Survey** — observing, reading the scene ●○○○

BODY — Body · Resistance 3d

- **Fight** — combat, melee, gunfire ●○○○
- **Finesse** — dexterity, precision, vehicles ●○○○
- **Prowl** — sneaking, climbing, hiding ●●○○
- **Wreck** ○○○○

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Practitioner of the Way REQUIRED

Way of the Body (Fight, Finesse, Prowl, Wreck): three of your starting dots lie there. You resist supernatural consequences with Body. You can never become Awakened or Emergent. Choose an adept drawback from the rulebook.

Adept Senses START

Spend 1 edge to perceive beyond normal limits for several minutes. Detect subtle environmental changes (temperature, frequency, pressure), sense the presence of danger, become a living lie detector.

GEAR · LOAD

0 • **Fine Mystic Body Art** Tattoos that focus your adept core. Supernaturally bonded, unique, painstaking to remove.

0 • **Strange Trinket** A small item, here a worn prayer chain, that shows visions of the past

METATYPE: MENSCH

Mensch. No special traits. By the rules you may instead pick up to two free permutations. Talk it over with the GM or skip it.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants: cyberware would weaken your magic. Your tattoos are Fine Mystic Body Art, a focus that carries your way.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a tough challenge with inner perfection or mystical power.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER — Willpower · Resistance 1d

Command orders, intimidation	○○○○
Consort rapport, networking, contacts	○○○○
Influence persuasion, deceit, charm	○○○○
Study analysis, knowledge, spellcasting	●○○○

EDGE — 9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM — level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 less effect	...	...
LEVEL 2 −1d	...	...
LEVEL 3 needs help	...	

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD — Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

or near future of a place, whether you want them or not.

2 **Fine Astral Weapon** A short staff effective against astral beings. For the Trial by Fire more ballast than help, unless the watcher comes closer.

1 • **A Quiet Weapon** Standard: throwing knives or a blowgun with tranquilizer darts. Quiet, light, usable non-lethally.

2 **Climbing Gear** Standard: grappling hooks and carabiners in case Prowl 2 is not enough for once.

• recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson’s pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Master Oyelaran, dojo owner in Georgetown. Trains half of Seattle’s security industry. He knows which guards stand in the Spire tonight, which of them are augmented and who gets careless after a 14-hour day.

RIVAL

Aurel Voss, adept in the service of a corporate security firm. Once trained beside Hush and considers this path a weakness. He advises security companies in Bellevue, occasionally Vesperline too.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You seek tasks that make you grow. A tower full of sensors, drones and a curator who must not be harmed is a test of your discipline. The money goes to the dojo. The test is yours.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Sensor corridor 110:** Adept Senses feel light barriers as warmth, pressure plates as unevenness, cameras as a hum. Prowl 2 carries you through.
- **Dr. Venn:** As a living lie detector you notice her turning suspicious before she shows it. Study to read her; Finesse to capture the iris scan unnoticed.
- **Conservatory glass roof:** The vent flap sticks mechanically, no sensor. Five meters of rope into soft plants is a step for you.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: THE AWAKENING AND THE ADEPTS

Magic has been back in the world since 2011. About one in a hundred people is Awakened: mages cast and summon, adepts channel mana into their own bodies and become faster, more alert, harder, without anyone seeing it. Cyberware and magic do not mix: every implant costs Essence and weakens the gift. Adepts like Hush therefore choose the body they have and make it the weapon.

GM ONLY

Hush’s aura is as bright in astral space as a mage’s. The watcher on 110 notices it just like a sorcerer (Alert +1 for astral activity nearby). The Strange Trinket is a tool for foreboding: in front of the vault door it can show a vision of a huge shadow gliding across the facade. A quiet foretaste of Veyrath without giving away the twist.

Ravn

MAGE | ORK | CORPORATE SIN CANCELLED

Mage: Awakened, hermetic, a view into astral space

NAME your choice · “Ravn” is just the street name

PRONOUNS she · he · they · …

Role in the run: Sees what nobody else sees: barriers, watchers, magical auras, the case among a hundred objects. Casts quietly and knows how corporate mages think.

PROFILE

LOOK	Mid forties, greying temples, strong polished tusks. Tweed jacket, reading glasses with a sensing focus, a ring of meteoric iron on the little finger.
HERITAGE	Europe · Kraków, transferred to Seattle on a corporate contract and stayed
BACKGROUND	Corporate · wage mage in a corporation’s magical security: check barriers, banish spirits, do not ask questions. You asked.
VICE	Weird · conversations with “Vesna”, a free spirit living in the empty library at Pike Place who only answers in rhymes
IDN (SIN)	Your corporate SIN was deleted with the dismissal. You live on a fake SIN, occupation: independent scholar.
CONTACTS	Strange Friends

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS

INTUITION — Intuition · Resistance 1d

Engineer	tech, tinkering, repairs
Interface	Matrix, hacking, controlling devices
Stalk	tracking, hunting, aiming
Survey	observing, reading the scene

BODY — Body · Resistance 1d

Fight	combat, melee, gunfire
Finesse	dexterity, precision, vehicles
Prowl	sneaking, climbing, hiding
Wreck	

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Awakened REQUIRED

Arcane method: hermetic tradition (choose drawbacks per the rulebook). You may roll the Assense action; when you roll a desperate Assense action, mark 1 karma on the Willpower track. Buy further Assense dots as a Willpower advance. Never Emergent or an adept.

Sorcerer START

You know the unique methods to activate metaplanar energies through your body to cast spells. You can Study a spell formula to summon a supernatural effect. You begin with two spells already learned.

TWO SPELLS LEARNED

Stunbolt

A surge of mana against a target’s mind: unconsciousness instead of wounds. Non-lethal, silent, visible only to the Awakened. Study, line of sight.

METATYPE: ORK

Low-light Vision. You can see in low light as well as if it were well lit.

Foolish Pride. Regain 1 edge when you roll a critical on a desperate action roll.

Numbskull. Spend 1 edge to ignore a harm penalty (including incapacitation) for an action.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants: every piece of chrome would weaken your magic. Your foci are glasses and ring.

KARMA TRIGGERS

You addressed a challenge with knowledge or magical power.

Always in addition: you expressed your beliefs, heritage or background · your vice or trauma caused trouble.

breaking, blasting, brute force

WILLPOWER — Willpower · Resistance 3d

Command — orders, intimidation ○○○○

Consort — rapport, networking, contacts ●○○○

Influence — persuasion, deceit, charm ●○○○

Study — analysis, knowledge, spellcasting ●●○○

SUPERNATURAL — Awakened · counts toward the 7 dots

Assense — perceive astrally, read barriers and spirits ●○○○

ÜBERNATÜRLICH

EDGE — 9 boxes · push 2 · assist 1

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Cold · Haunted · Obsessed · Paranoid · Reckless · Soft · Unstable · Vicious

HARM — level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 1 — less effect	...	...
LEVEL 2 — −1d	...	...
LEVEL 3 — needs help	...	

> **Veil**
> An illusion over a person or thing: different clothes, another face, a case that looks like a briefcase. Lasts as long as you concentrate. It fools people, not cameras.

GEAR · LOAD

1	•	**Fine Spell Focus** The ring of meteoric iron: wield spells with exceptional control.
1	•	**Fine Sensing Focus** Glasses through which you see arcane energies in great detail. Also some protection against possession.
0	•	**Banishing Focus** A small arcane amulet that astral beings prefer to avoid.
1		**Fine Arcane Reagents** Grave dust, prayer beads, awakened feathers: concentrated essence for big spells, deteriorates after use.
0		**A Paracritter** An awakened animal as a companion (cohort, expert). Ravn has none; Vesna would supposedly be jealous.

• recommended for the Trial by Fire. Standard gear anytime: Comm (0), Armor (2), Pistol (1), Burglary Gear (1), Climbing Gear (2), Subterfuge Supplies (1) and more.

ARMOR

☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Special

LOAD Light 3 · Normal 5 · Heavy 6

○ Light 3 ◉ Normal 5 ○ Heavy 6

NUYEN start 2 · stash 0

Johnson's pay: 6 nuyen for the crew on a clean handover.

RESET TRACKERS

FRIEND

Talia Vance, talismonger in Tacoma. Deals in foci and reagents and hears everything Seattle's Awakened gossip about. She has heard that the barrier in the Meridian Spire was drawn by a master nobody knows.

RIVAL

Dr. Henrik Solvay, Ravn's former supervisor. Still runs the magical security of the former corporation and has marked Ravn's file "unreliable, monitor whereabouts".

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

For twelve years you drew barriers for people who never told you what lay behind them. Now, for once, you want to know what is behind a wall built this well. The nuyen pay for Vesna's library. The curiosity you pay yourself.

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- **Vault 110:** Assense shows you the dual mana barrier, the living tissue and the watcher on its rounds. At the doorway you see how the barrier is opened in a controlled way: an advantage for any way in of your own.
- **The collection:** The case carries a faint, old aura. Among a hundred glittering things it is the only one that whispers to you. You also see which antiques are magical and which are merely expensive.
- **Stunbolt & Veil:** A guard sleeps, a runner looks like staff, the case looks like a briefcase. Non-lethal, silent, exactly as Johnson demanded.

SHADOWRUN INSIGHT: HERMETICS, ASTRAL SPACE AND DRAGONS

Awakened mages follow traditions: hermetics treat magic as a science of formulas and circles, shamans as a relationship with spirits and mentors. Astral space is the second layer of the world, where thoughts have colors and barriers stand like walls. At the very top stand the Great Dragons: ancient, unimaginably rich, seated on corporate boards. Some walls were not built for people.

GM ONLY

Ravn recognizes the vault shell as a cultivated dual barrier: a technique that costs decades and a fortune. No corporation builds that for art. That is the trail to Veyrath without giving away the twist. Before the run Vesna told Ravn in rhymes that the tower “has a heartbeat”. The watcher reports astral activity (Alert +1) but does not attack; Ravn can distract it with Assense or stay still. Solvay is a Heat complication for after the run.